

ENGLISH FOR NAIL SERVICES

Nail Technician English

Precise details. Clear agreement.

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Eight scenarios. Eight extended conversations.

INSIDE THE BOOK

192 vocabulary entries / 128 reusable phrases

160 dialogue turns / 80 numbered dialogue gaps

Word banks and explained answer keys

Upper-intermediate to advanced (B2-C1). For nail technicians, salon receptionists, assistants, and nail-service team leads.

2026 edition

Eight scenarios. Eight skills.

Eight nail-service conversations: clarify an overlay, compare shapes, separate finish from coverage, quote nail art, respond to tenderness, confirm station readiness, review design direction, and hand over an unbooked request.

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The picture is long; the request is short | Clarify the desired length before treating an ambiguous service label or reference photograph as an instruction.

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Small details change the whole request.

A useful nail-service conversation separates length, shape, color, coverage, finish, product, design placement, price, and permission. Confirming those details prevents a familiar label or attractive reference from silently replacing what the client actually wants.

Describe before naming

A client may say full set while wanting no added length. Ask about the desired result before assuming that the service label or long reference image settles the request.

"You want the current short length retained; no extensions are requested."

Keep visual dimensions separate

Matte concerns shine, sheer concerns coverage, and pink concerns color. None of those words by itself identifies a product system or confirms that a particular service is suitable.

"Low shine and a visible nail line are the appearance preferences; product selection is still open."

Quote the whole option

When nail art is charged per nail, give the number of decorated nails and the total including the base service. A lower quantity should not become an unannounced reduction in the agreed design.

"Two decorated nails add \$10 to the \$30 base service, for a \$40 total."

State the exact stage

A tidy station may still await required checks. A review is not a promised correction, a consultation request is not a booking, and a health referral does not approve a cosmetic service.

"Station two is confirmed ready; station three still has incomplete checks."

PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES

All clients, salons, prices, sample descriptions, and incidents are fictional. This book teaches workplace English, not nail procedures, product removal, disinfection methods, medical diagnosis, treatment, or legal requirements. Follow professional training, current product instructions, actual salon procedures, applicable local rules, and emergency arrangements. Health concerns belong with an appropriate healthcare professional; cosmetic-service suitability requires its own salon assessment. No example authorizes covering an unexplained concern with product.

The picture is long; the request is short

A Read the situation

Clarify the desired length before treating an ambiguous service label or reference photograph as an instruction.

Client Zoe booked an overlay but calls the appointment a full set when speaking to technician Lin. Zoe points to a long reference image, then explains that the current short length should be kept. No work has begun. Lin clarifies that the intended discussion is a natural-nail overlay without adding length, not automatically extensions. The image is a reference for the look, not permission to copy its length. Product choice, any further design details, and suitability still need the normal consultation.

PEOPLE / Zoe: Client | Lin: Nail technician

CHECK THE MEANING WITHOUT CORRECTING THE PERSON

Clients often learn service words from friends, menus, or social media, where the same label may be used differently. Ask what result they want, explain the relevant distinction plainly, and avoid making the client feel that knowing the salon vocabulary was a condition of asking.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What length does Zoe want?

- | | |
|--|--|
| A An unspecified amount added | B The current short length retained |
| C The full length in the photograph | D A longer extension on every nail |

2. What was booked?

- | | |
|--|-------------------------------------|
| A A completed full set | B An overlay |
| C A confirmed extension service | D A removal appointment only |

3. What does the reference image authorize by itself?

- | | |
|-----------------------------------|---|
| A Extensions on every nail | B Any product the technician chooses |
| C A guaranteed exact match | D No automatic length change |

Answers and explanations: [page 76](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

natural nail

Client's own nail rather than an added enhancement.

IN USE identify the natural nail

nail plate

Hard visible part of the natural nail.

IN USE refer to the nail plate

nail bed

Tissue beneath the nail plate.

IN USE distinguish nail bed and plate

free edge

Part of the nail extending beyond its attachment at the fingertip.

IN USE discuss the free edge

overlay

Coating over a nail surface; the exact service needs clarification.

IN USE clarify the overlay

natural-nail overlay

Coating applied over the existing natural nail without necessarily adding length.

IN USE discuss a natural-nail overlay

extension

Added length beyond the existing natural nail.

IN USE confirm whether extensions are wanted

enhancement

Added material used to change nail appearance or structure.

IN USE clarify the enhancement

full set

Common service label whose intended scope must be confirmed.

IN USE clarify the full-set request

tip

Preformed component used in some nail-extension services.

IN USE identify an extension tip

form

Temporary support used in some sculpted-enhancement services.

IN USE distinguish a form from a tip

builder gel

Gel product category used to create enhancement structure.

IN USE discuss builder gel terminology

Precision check

Overlay is a broad coating term, and full set can be used loosely. In this conversation, the client wants a natural-nail overlay at the current short length, with no extensions requested. Confirm the result before relying on either label.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

acrylic

Common salon term for liquid-and-powder enhancement systems.

IN USE clarify the acrylic service

gel polish

Light-cured color-coating category, distinct from all enhancement services.

IN USE distinguish gel polish

lacquer

Conventional nail-polish category, distinct from gel polish.

IN USE identify nail lacquer

service label

Name used on a booking or menu.

IN USE clarify the service label

reference image

Picture used to discuss selected visual features.

IN USE interpret the reference image

retained length

Existing length the client wants to keep.

IN USE confirm retained length

added length

Extra length created by an extension service.

IN USE decline added length

current length

Length present before the proposed service begins.

IN USE check the current length

length preference

Client's stated choice about how long the result should be.

IN USE record the length preference

consultation

Discussion of the request, suitability, and proposed service.

IN USE complete the consultation

service scope

Specific work included in the agreed appointment.

IN USE confirm the service scope

read-back

Repetition of key details to verify understanding.

IN USE give a length read-back

Precision check

A gel-polish color service and a structural enhancement are not interchangeable labels. The desired short length does not select a product system or establish suitability. Keep those decisions within the actual consultation and professional process.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

CLARIFY THE LABEL

"When you say full set, do you mean added length?"

REFER TO THE BOOKING

"Your booking currently says overlay."

CONFIRM THE PRACTICAL CHOICE

"You want your current short length retained."

KEEP EXTENSIONS SEPARATE

"No extensions are requested at this stage."

ASK ABOUT THE RESULT

"Would you like to keep your current length?"

SEPARATE IMAGE AND INSTRUCTION

"The photo shows long nails, but we should confirm your own length preference."

EXPLAIN THE PROPOSED TERM

"We are discussing a natural-nail overlay without added length."

AVOID A PRODUCT ASSUMPTION

"We have not selected the product system yet."

Keep versus add

Keep preserves the existing length; add proposes an extension.

Full set

Confirm what the client means instead of treating the label as self-explanatory.

Natural-nail overlay

This specifies the surface and avoids assuming the overlay includes an extension tip.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CHECK THE VISUAL FEATURE

"Which part of the image do you want to use as a reference?"

AVOID EMBARRASSMENT

"Service names can be used differently; the result you want is what matters."

INVITE CORRECTION

"Please correct me if short does not describe what you mean."

READ BACK THE REQUEST

"Current short length, natural-nail overlay discussion, no extensions."

CONFIRM BEFORE STARTING

"No work has begun, so let us settle the details first."

DISTINGUISH SCOPE

"Adding length would be a different part of the service discussion."

KEEP ASSESSMENT OPEN

"Suitability still needs the normal consultation."

CLOSE THE CLARIFICATION

"The picture does not override your confirmed length preference."

Reference only

An image may illustrate one feature without authorizing all of them.

At this stage

The current request is clear while product and suitability decisions remain open.

Read-back

Repeating the agreed length catches a consequential misunderstanding before work starts.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which question resolves the key ambiguity?

- A** Does full set always mean extensions?
- B** Do you want added length, or your current short length kept?
- C** Which payment method do you prefer?
- D** Shall I copy the longest nail in the picture?

2. Which summary is accurate?

- A** The reference authorizes an exact copy.
- B** Natural-nail overlay discussion at current short length, with no extensions requested.
- C** Long extensions confirmed from the image.
- D** Product system selected by the word short.

3. Which product statement is supported?

- A** Gel polish and every builder gel are the same.
- B** Acrylic is required whenever a photo is long.
- C** No consultation is needed for short nails.
- D** Product selection still needs clarification.

4. Which response avoids blaming the client for terminology?

- A** Everyone knows full set has one meaning.
- B** We must copy the photo because you brought it.
- C** Service names vary; let us confirm the result you want.
- D** You booked incorrectly, so no questions are allowed.

[Answers and explanations: page 76.](#)

The picture is long; the request is short

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

natural-nail overlay / reference image / service scope / product categories / retained length / read-back / service label / extensions / overlay / length preference

- 01 **Zoe:** I am here for my full set. I brought this picture, but I should say that I do not want my nails as long as those.
- 02 **Lin:** Thank you for clarifying. Your booking says ¹ _____. When you say full set, are you asking for added length, or would you like to keep the length you have now?
- 03 **Zoe:** I want to keep them short, as they are now. I used full set because that is the phrase I have heard other people use.
- 04 **Lin:** That is fine. The ² _____ can mean different things in conversation. Let us focus on the result you want rather than assume the word settles the details.
- 05 **Zoe:** The photo is really just to show the general look I liked. The length in it would not work for me day to day.
- 06 **Lin:** Then we will treat it as a ³ _____, not an instruction to copy every feature. Your own length preference takes priority over the long nails shown in the picture.
- 07 **Zoe:** Good. I was worried that showing the image after saying full set might make it sound as though I had already agreed to extensions.
- 08 **Lin:** No ⁴ _____ are requested at this stage. We are clarifying a service that keeps your current short length instead of adding the photographed length.
- 09 **Zoe:** Is natural-nail overlay the more precise phrase for the discussion, then? I want to understand what to say without choosing the wrong material.
- 10 **Lin:** Yes, ⁵ _____ describes what we are discussing here. It does not by itself decide which product is appropriate, so we will keep that part open.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 10.

- 11 **Zoe:** That helps. I have also heard gel polish and builder gel, and I had assumed those names were interchangeable because both contain gel.
- 12 **Lin:** They are different ⁶ _____. We should clarify the actual service and product rather than treating similar words as proof that they do the same job.
- 13 **Zoe:** So keeping the nails short tells you my length preference, but it does not finish the consultation or select a particular product for me.
- 14 **Lin:** Correct. Your ⁷ _____ is clear, while product choice, suitability, and any further design details still need the normal consultation before we proceed.
- 15 **Zoe:** Please keep that in the note. I would like the next person who sees the booking to understand that I have not asked for anything longer.
- 16 **Lin:** I will make the ⁸ _____ clear: an overlay discussion at your current short length, with no added length requested. That is more useful than leaving only the phrase full set.
- 17 **Zoe:** Could you read it back once more? I want to make sure the long photograph has not remained the main instruction after all these questions.
- 18 **Lin:** The ⁹ _____ is: keep the current short length, discuss a natural-nail overlay, and do not add extensions. The photograph is only a reference for further discussion.
- 19 **Zoe:** Yes, that is what I want. I am glad we checked before anything started instead of discovering later that we meant different things.
- 20 **Lin:** No work has begun. We have settled the ¹⁰ _____ and can continue the consultation from that clear starting point, without assuming the image or the service name answers every remaining question.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. overlay | 2. service label | 3. reference image | 4. extensions | 5. natural-nail overlay | 6. product categories | 7. retained length | 8. service scope | 9. read-back | 10. length preference

Clarify another overlay request

F Say it

A client shows a long reference but wants the existing medium length retained. The discussion is a natural-nail overlay with no extensions requested. Product choice is still open, and no work has begun.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

extensions / open / begun / medium

Technician: "The current ¹ _____ length should be retained."

Client: "No ² _____ are requested."

Technician: "Product choice remains ³ _____."

Client: "No work has ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 77

1. medium | 2. extensions | 3. open | 4. begun

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

A shape that fits the working day

A Read the situation

Compare sample silhouettes and lengths while preserving a practical requirement and avoiding unsupported durability claims.

Client Amara likes a long almond sample but needs a short result for keyboard work. Technician Kai also has a short squoval sample, with a straighter free-edge outline and softened corners. The almond sample narrows toward a rounded tip and is visibly longer. Amara chooses the short squoval appearance for discussion. No method, exact measurement, or guarantee against breakage or discomfort is established. Kai must distinguish the visible comparison from a promise about how either shape will perform on the actual nails.

PEOPLE / Amara: Client | Kai: Nail technician

A PRACTICAL PREFERENCE IS NOT A LESSER CHOICE

Avoid praising one shape as universally better or more professional. Ask how the client uses their hands, compare the supplied samples neutrally, and preserve the stated length limit. The client should not feel pressured to copy a dramatic display sample.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What practical requirement does Amara state?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A A short result for keyboard work | B The longest possible extension |
| C A guaranteed unbreakable shape | D A specified filing method |

2. Which sample is short in this case?

- | | |
|-------------------------------------|--------------------------------------|
| A The squoval sample | B The almond sample |
| C Both are described as long | D Neither sample has a length |

3. What does Amara choose for discussion?

- | | |
|---|---------------------------------------|
| A An unassessed extension method | B The short squoval appearance |
| C A guaranteed damage-proof result | D The exact long almond sample |

Answers and explanations: page 78.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

silhouette

Outer visible outline of a nail shape.

IN USE compare the silhouettes

almond

Shape narrowing toward a rounded, almond-like tip.

IN USE describe the almond sample

squoval

Shape combining a straighter edge with softened corners.

IN USE explain the squoval outline

square

Shape with a straighter free edge and more defined corners.

IN USE identify the square shape

round

Shape with a rounded free-edge outline.

IN USE compare a round shape

oval

Elongated rounded shape without a sharply pointed tip.

IN USE describe an oval outline

stiletto

Shape narrowing to a pronounced pointed tip.

IN USE identify the stiletto sample

coffin

Tapered shape ending in a comparatively flat tip.

IN USE describe the coffin silhouette

tapered sides

Side outlines that narrow toward the tip.

IN USE compare tapered sides

rounded tip

Tip with a curved rather than sharp endpoint.

IN USE identify the rounded tip

softened corners

Corners with a gentler rounded outline.

IN USE describe softened corners

straight edge

Outline appearing relatively flat across the end.

IN USE identify the straight edge

Precision check

This comparison concerns the two supplied samples: long almond and short squoval. Squoval describes an outline, not an absolute length in every salon. The selected short appearance still needs an agreed length reference and normal assessment.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

sample display

Set of examples used to compare visible choices.

IN USE use the sample display

length reference

Agreed example or measurement used to discuss length.

IN USE confirm a length reference

practical requirement

Everyday need affecting the client's preference.

IN USE record the practical requirement

keyboard work

Work involving regular typing or use of keys.

IN USE discuss keyboard work

daily use

How the client normally uses their hands.

IN USE ask about daily use

preferred outline

Shape the client selects for discussion.

IN USE confirm the preferred outline

symmetry

Visual balance between corresponding sides or nails.

IN USE discuss symmetry

proportion

Relationship between dimensions such as length and width.

IN USE compare proportions

breakage

Breaking of a nail or enhancement, not prevented by a verbal guarantee.

IN USE avoid a breakage guarantee

comfort expectation

What the client hopes will feel manageable in use.

IN USE clarify the comfort expectation

measurement

Specific quantified length, not established by a broad label alone.

IN USE agree on a measurement

suitability assessment

Professional review of whether the proposed service fits the actual situation.

IN USE complete a suitability assessment

Precision check

A client can prefer short nails for keyboard work without proving that every short shape will be comfortable or resistant to breakage. Describe appearance and practical priorities; do not convert a preference into a performance guarantee.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ASK ABOUT DAILY USE

"What length feels practical for your keyboard work?"

IDENTIFY THE CONFLICT

"This particular almond sample is longer than your stated preference."

EXPLAIN THE CORNERS

"It has a straighter edge with softened corners."

SEPARATE SHAPE AND LENGTH

"Let us compare the outline and the length as two details."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE ATTRACTION

"You like the almond outline in this sample."

DESCRIBE THE ALTERNATIVE

"The squoval sample shown here is short."

EXPLAIN THE ALMOND TIP

"The almond sample narrows toward a rounded tip."

PRESERVE THE PRACTICAL LIMIT

"Your priority is a short result."

Shape versus length

Almond and squoval describe outlines; long and short describe relative length.

This sample

Limits the claim to the example being compared rather than every version of the shape.

Closer to

Expresses preference without promising an exact photographic copy.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

AVOID A DURABILITY PROMISE

"I cannot promise that either shape prevents breakage."

CHECK THE CHOSEN APPEARANCE

"Is the short squoval sample closer to what you want?"

CONFIRM A REFERENCE

"We still need a clear length reference for your actual nails."

READ BACK THE PRIORITY

"Short length for keyboard work, with the squoval appearance preferred."

AVOID A COMFORT GUARANTEE

"The sample alone cannot establish how it will feel in daily use."

LEAVE THE METHOD OPEN

"We have not agreed on a technical method yet."

KEEP THE COMPARISON NEUTRAL

"The shapes look different; neither is automatically better for everyone."

CONFIRM BEFORE PROCEEDING

"We will settle the remaining details before starting."

Need versus guarantee

A practical need informs assessment but does not establish performance.

Rounded versus round

A rounded tip can appear within an almond shape; round is also a whole-shape label.

Before starting

Length and method questions should be resolved before an irreversible change.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which comparison is accurate?

- A** This almond sample is long and tapered; this squoval sample is short with softened corners.
- B** Every almond nail has the same length.
- C** Squoval guarantees no breakage.
- D** The short sample proves every service is suitable.

2. Which question best clarifies the next detail?

- A** Shall I assume the long sample overrides your work needs?
- B** Do you accept a guaranteed unbreakable result?
- C** Can we skip the consultation because the sample is short?
- D** What length reference shall we agree on for your actual nails?

3. Which promise is unsupported?

- A** No method has been agreed yet.
- B** This shape will never cause discomfort or break.
- C** The squoval sample has softened corners.
- D** You prefer short length for keyboard work.

4. What does the selected sample establish?

- A** An exact universal measurement
- B** An approved technical procedure
- C** A guarantee for every daily task
- D** A preferred appearance for discussion

Answers and explanations: page 78.

A shape that fits the working day

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

preferred outline / almond / breakage / comfort guarantee / practical requirement / Softened corners / silhouettes / length reference / suitability assessment / squoval

- 01 **Amara:** I like this almond sample, but it looks much longer than I could manage at work. I spend most of the day using a keyboard.
- 02 **Kai:** The ¹ _____ is a short result, then. We can compare the shape you like without assuming you want the full length of this display sample.
- 03 **Amara:** Yes. I like the way it narrows, but I do not want to agree to that length just because I point to it.
- 04 **Kai:** The ² _____ outline narrows toward a rounded tip. In this particular sample, that outline is shown at a visibly longer length.
- 05 **Amara:** What is the name of the shorter one beside it? The end looks straighter, but the corners do not look sharply square.
- 06 **Kai:** That is the ³ _____ sample. It combines a straighter end with softened corners, and the example here is short.
- 07 **Amara:** I think that is closer to what I need. Can we compare them without deciding on a product or method yet?
- 08 **Kai:** Certainly. We are comparing the ⁴ _____ and lengths first. The technical method and the appropriate service still need their own discussion.
- 09 **Amara:** The shorter one seems less likely to get in my way. Does that mean it will definitely be comfortable when I type?
- 10 **Kai:** I cannot give a ⁵ _____ from a sample. Your work needs help guide the consultation, but they do not prove how a particular result will feel on your actual nails.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 19.

- 11 **Amara:** Understood. I have also heard people say one shape never breaks. That sounded too definite to me.
- 12 **Kai:** A ⁶ _____ promise like that would be too strong. We can discuss your preferences and the assessment without claiming a shape is unbreakable.
- 13 **Amara:** Then let us use the short squoval as the appearance I prefer. I do not want the long almond length copied.
- 14 **Kai:** I will record the ⁷ _____ and your short-length priority together. That keeps the visual choice connected to the practical reason you gave.
- 15 **Amara:** Does short need a more exact explanation before we begin? It may mean something different to another person.
- 16 **Kai:** Yes, we still need an agreed ⁸ _____ for your actual nails. The word short is useful, but it should not be the only detail in the final agreement.
- 17 **Amara:** Good. Please keep the softened corners in the discussion too. That is part of what I like about the second sample.
- 18 **Kai:** I will. ⁹ _____ are part of the visible shape you prefer, separate from the exact length we still need to confirm.
- 19 **Amara:** So the next step is to confirm those details, not to assume that choosing the sample has answered every service question.
- 20 **Kai:** Correct. The ¹⁰ _____ and remaining details still matter. We have a clear direction: short length for keyboard work, with the squoval appearance preferred.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. practical requirement | 2. almond | 3. squoval | 4. silhouettes | 5. comfort guarantee | 6. breakage | 7. preferred outline | 8. length reference | 9. Softened corners | 10. suitability assessment

Separate shape from a guarantee

F Say it

A client compares a long oval sample with a short round sample. They choose the short round appearance for keyboard work. No exact measurement or guarantee against breakage is agreed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

short / breakage / round / measurement

Technician: "The preferred shape is ¹ _____."

Client: "My practical priority is ² _____ length."

Technician: "The exact ³ _____ still needs agreement."

Client: "No guarantee against ⁴ _____ has been made."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 79

1. round | 2. short | 3. measurement | 4. breakage

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Sheer pink, without the shine

A Read the situation

03

Separate color, coverage, and finish while leaving an unspecified product system open for consultation.

Client Dana asks technician Noor for matte pink but points to a sheer glossy swatch. Dana explains that the desired result has low shine while the natural nail line remains visible. The selected swatch illustrates the preferred pink color and transparency, but not the preferred finish. The booking does not specify conventional lacquer or gel polish. Noor records the appearance as sheer pink with a low-shine finish, leaving product selection and suitability open rather than assuming the swatch chooses the whole service.

PEOPLE / Dana: Client | Noor: Nail technician

SEPARATE THE DETAILS KINDLY

A client is not being inconsistent when one sample illustrates only part of a request. Ask which features they like and translate the answer into separate appearance choices. Avoid overwhelming the client with product names before the desired color, coverage, and finish are clear.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which appearance does Dana want?

- A Sheer pink with low shine
- C Clear colorless polish with glitter

- B Opaque pink with high gloss
- D Every feature of the glossy swatch

2. What should remain visible?

- A Only a solid opaque coating
- C An extension form

- B A confirmed product label
- D The natural nail line

3. Which product category is booked?

- A Gel polish is confirmed
- C Both are automatically selected

- B Lacquer is confirmed
- D Neither lacquer nor gel polish is specified

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

swatch

Sample showing a color or finish for comparison.

IN USE compare the swatch

shade

Particular variation of a color.

IN USE choose a pink shade

hue

Basic color family, such as pink or red.

IN USE describe the hue

undertone

Subtle underlying color character.

IN USE compare undertones

coverage

Degree to which the applied color conceals what is beneath it.

IN USE clarify the coverage

sheer

Translucent enough for some underlying nail detail to remain visible.

IN USE request sheer coverage

semi-sheer

Partially translucent, between very sheer and fully opaque.

IN USE compare semi-sheer coverage

opaque

Concealing the underlying nail rather than allowing it to show through.

IN USE distinguish opaque coverage

translucency

Degree to which light and underlying detail show through.

IN USE describe translucency

nail line

Visible boundary toward the nail's free edge, used here as an appearance reference.

IN USE retain a visible nail line

finish

Surface appearance, including the level of shine.

IN USE clarify the finish

matte

Low-shine or non-glossy surface appearance.

IN USE request a matte finish

Precision check

Matte and sheer answer different questions. Matte concerns shine; sheer concerns how much underlying nail remains visible. The client can request both. The glossy swatch illustrates the preferred color and coverage, not the agreed final shine.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

glossy

Shiny surface appearance.

IN USE identify the glossy swatch

satin

Soft-sheen appearance between matte and high gloss in a given range.

IN USE compare a satin finish

sheen

Degree of reflected shine.

IN USE describe the sheen

shimmer

Fine reflective sparkle within a color effect.

IN USE identify shimmer

glitter

Visible reflective particles used for a decorative effect.

IN USE distinguish glitter from gloss

metallic

Appearance resembling reflective metal.

IN USE describe a metallic effect

pearlescent

Soft luminous effect resembling the sheen of a pearl.

IN USE compare a pearlescent effect

top coat

Finishing coating whose properties depend on the product system.

IN USE discuss the top coat

color coat

Layer providing the selected color effect.

IN USE identify the color coat

product system

Compatible set of products and procedures for a service.

IN USE confirm the product system

appearance specification

Separate agreed details of color, coverage, and finish.

IN USE record the appearance specification

sample mismatch

Difference between a sample feature and the client's actual preference.

IN USE clarify the sample mismatch

Precision check

A swatch is not a product-selection shortcut. The booking does not identify lacquer or gel polish, and the appearance request does not determine compatibility, suitability, or application steps. Those details remain within the actual consultation.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

03

SEPARATE THE CHOICES

"Let us check color, coverage, and finish one at a time."

ASK ABOUT VISIBILITY

"Do you want the natural nail line to remain visible?"

EXPLAIN OPAQUE

"Opaque coverage conceals the underlying nail."

DESCRIBE THE SWATCH

"This swatch is sheer and glossy."

CONFIRM THE COLOR

"Pink is the color you prefer."

EXPLAIN SHEER

"Sheer coverage allows some nail detail to show through."

EXPLAIN MATTE

"Matte describes a low-shine finish."

IDENTIFY THE MISMATCH

"You like its pink color and coverage, but not its shine."

Coverage versus finish

Coverage concerns concealment; finish concerns surface appearance.

Sheer versus clear

Sheer color can be tinted while still allowing underlying detail to show.

Matte versus opaque

Low shine does not necessarily mean full concealment of the nail.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

03

CONFIRM THE COMBINED REQUEST

"You want sheer pink with a low-shine finish."

CLARIFY THE BOOKING

"The booking does not specify lacquer or gel polish."

AVOID COPYING EVERYTHING

"Selecting this swatch does not select every feature it shows."

AVOID AN APPLICATION PROMISE

"We have not confirmed the product or method yet."

AVOID A FALSE CONFLICT

"Sheer and matte describe different features, so they are not opposites."

KEEP PRODUCT CHOICE OPEN

"We still need to discuss the product system."

ASK FOR A READ-BACK

"Is visible nail line and low shine the right summary?"

CLOSE THE APPEARANCE DISCUSSION

"The appearance is clear; product selection remains open."

But not

This phrase selects some sample features while explicitly rejecting another.

Unspecified

An absent product category is a question to clarify, not permission to guess.

One at a time

Separating dimensions reduces confusion without turning the conversation into a lecture.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which statement explains the client's request?

- A** Pink automatically means gel polish.
- B** Sheer concerns visibility through the color; matte concerns shine.
- C** Sheer always means glossy.
- D** Matte always means opaque.

2. Which swatch feature is not wanted?

- A** Its sheer coverage
- B** Its visible underlying detail
- C** Its glossy finish
- D** Its pink color

3. Which record is accurate?

- A** Colorless glitter, lacquer confirmed.
- B** Every swatch feature accepted without discussion.
- C** Sheer pink, low shine, product category not yet specified.
- D** Glossy opaque pink, gel polish confirmed.

4. Which question best checks coverage?

- A** Do you want the nail line to show through?
- B** Would you like a shinier surface?
- C** What time is your appointment?
- D** Which payment card will you use?

Answers and explanations: [page 80](#).

Sheer pink, without the shine

E Conversations / turns 1-10

03

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

Opaque / sample mismatch / product system / sheer / coverage / product category / appearance specification / finish / matte / nail line

- 01 **Dana:** I would like matte pink, something like this sample. I like being able to see a little of the nail underneath it.
- 02 **Noor:** Let us check the ¹ _____ first. Do you want the natural nail line to remain visible through the pink, rather than have it completely hidden?
- 03 **Dana:** Yes, I want that line to show. I do not want a solid block of color, even though I want the surface less shiny.
- 04 **Noor:** Then ² _____ is the useful word for the coverage. It describes what shows through, not how shiny the surface is.
- 05 **Dana:** That is the distinction I was missing. I thought sheer might mean shiny because the samples I noticed were all glossy.
- 06 **Noor:** The ³ _____ is a separate feature. This particular swatch is both sheer and glossy, but those words describe different things.
- 07 **Dana:** So I can like the pink and the see-through quality without asking you to copy the shine in the sample.
- 08 **Noor:** Exactly. Your ⁴ _____ preference means low shine. We can record that alongside the sheer pink appearance instead of treating the sample as an all-or-nothing choice.
- 09 **Dana:** Good. What would opaque mean in that comparison? I have seen it in descriptions but was not sure how it would look.
- 10 **Noor:** ⁵ _____ means the underlying nail is concealed by the color. That would not describe your wish to keep the nail line visible.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

03

Continue with the word bank on page 28.

- 11 **Dana:** Then opaque is not what I mean. Please keep the transparency of this one as the reference, but change the shine preference in the note.
- 12 **Noor:** I will describe the ⁶ _____ clearly. You like the color and coverage shown, while the glossy surface is not the finish you are requesting.
- 13 **Dana:** Does pointing to this sample also tell you whether I have booked gel polish? I do not remember choosing that when I made the appointment.
- 14 **Noor:** The ⁷ _____ is not specified in your booking. We still need to discuss lacquer or gel polish rather than infer that choice from the sample.
- 15 **Dana:** I would like that explained separately. I want to settle the appearance first, then understand the service options before agreeing.
- 16 **Noor:** That makes sense. The ⁸ _____ is sheer pink with low shine. Product choice and suitability remain part of the consultation.
- 17 **Dana:** Could you repeat the appearance using the ordinary words too? I want to be sure I can explain it again if someone else asks.
- 18 **Noor:** Pink color, a visible ⁹ _____, and a surface that is not glossy. That is the same request expressed without relying only on the technical labels.
- 19 **Dana:** Yes, that is exactly it. The sample is close in two ways, but the shine is the part I do not want copied.
- 20 **Noor:** I will keep those details separate when we discuss the ¹⁰ _____. We have clarified the appearance without assuming a product, a method, or every feature of the swatch.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. coverage | 2. sheer | 3. finish | 4. matte | 5. Opaque | 6. sample mismatch | 7. product category | 8. appearance specification | 9. nail line | 10. product system

Decode another color request

F Say it

A client wants opaque blue with a glossy finish. They do not want the nail line visible. The booking leaves lacquer versus gel polish unspecified.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

glossy / unspecified / blue / opaque

Technician: "The requested color is ¹ _____."

Client: "I want ² _____ coverage."

Technician: "The requested finish is ³ _____."

Reception: "The product category remains ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 81

1. blue | 2. opaque | 3. glossy | 4. unspecified

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Two accent nails within forty dollars

A Read the situation

Calculate a per-nail addition, offer complete priced alternatives, and confirm quantity and placement before starting.

Client Ben wants simple line art on four nails but has a total limit of \$40. Technician Rosa explains this fictional menu: the base service is \$30, simple line art is \$5 per nail, and no other charges apply in the exercise. Four decorated nails would cost \$50. Two decorated nails would cost \$40, or the base service alone would cost \$30. Ben chooses two decorated nails, one ring fingernail on each hand. Rosa confirms that two means the total across both hands, not two on each hand.

PEOPLE / Ben: Client | Rosa: Nail technician

MAKE THE QUANTITY VISIBLE IN THE PRICE

Per-nail charges can be misunderstood as per-hand or whole-set prices. State the quantity, the additional amount, and the complete total together. Offering a smaller design within a budget is helpful only if the client explicitly chooses the change.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What would four decorated nails cost in total?

A \$35

B \$50

C \$40

D \$20

2. Which option meets the \$40 limit with art?

A Two decorated nails plus the base service

B Four decorated nails plus the base service

C Two decorated nails on each hand

D The art charge alone without the base

3. Which placement is selected?

A One ring fingernail on each hand

B Two nails on each hand

C Four nails on the left hand

D All ten nails

Answers and explanations: page 82.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

nail art

Decorative design added to the nail appearance.

IN USE specify the nail art

line art

Design formed primarily with lines.

IN USE quote simple line art

accent nail

Nail given a distinct decorative treatment from the others.

IN USE select an accent nail

decorated nail

Nail included in the agreed art quantity.

IN USE count decorated nails

plain color

Color without the additional decorative design.

IN USE choose plain color

placement

Specific nail or area where the design appears.

IN USE confirm design placement

orientation

Direction in which a design faces.

IN USE clarify the orientation

motif

Repeated or distinct decorative element.

IN USE choose a motif

stripe

Long narrow decorative line or band.

IN USE describe a stripe

dot detail

Decorative element made of small dots.

IN USE clarify the dot detail

negative space

Deliberately uncovered area within a design.

IN USE identify negative space

French tip

Design emphasizing a contrasting appearance at the nail tip.

IN USE discuss a French-tip design

Precision check

Four decorated nails cost \$20 in art charges, making \$50 with the base service. Two decorated nails cost \$10 in art charges, making \$40 total. Two on each hand would be four in total and exceed the stated budget.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

ombre

Gradual visual transition between colors or tones.

IN USE describe an ombre effect

per-nail charge

Price applying to each decorated nail individually.

IN USE explain the per-nail charge

base price

Cost of the underlying service before art additions.

IN USE state the base price

art subtotal

Total charge for the decorative additions alone.

IN USE calculate the art subtotal

complete quote

Total price for the specifically described option.

IN USE give a complete quote

budget limit

Maximum total the client agrees to spend.

IN USE respect the budget limit

quantity reduction

Decrease in the number of decorated nails.

IN USE confirm a quantity reduction

ring fingernail

Nail on the finger between the middle and little fingers.

IN USE identify the ring fingernail

each hand

Separately referring to the left and right hands.

IN USE confirm one on each hand

both hands

Referring to the two hands together.

IN USE total across both hands

design approval

Agreement to the specified design and placement.

IN USE obtain design approval

additional charge

Amount added beyond the base service.

IN USE state the additional charge

Precision check

The accepted option is two decorated nails in total, specifically one ring fingernail on each hand. Do not quietly reduce the original four-nail request or increase the selected two-nail version. Quantity and placement both need agreement.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ASK ABOUT THE LIMIT

"Is \$40 your total budget, including the base service?"

EXPLAIN THE UNIT CHARGE

"Simple line art is \$5 per decorated nail."

OFFER THE SMALLER OPTION

"Two decorated nails add \$10, making \$40 total."

KEEP TOTALS COMPLETE

"These totals include the base service and the stated art quantity."

STATE THE BASE PRICE

"The base service is \$30."

CALCULATE THE FIRST OPTION

"Four decorated nails add \$20, making \$50 total."

PRESERVE THE PLAIN OPTION

"The base service alone is \$30."

ASK FOR A CHOICE

"Would you prefer two decorated nails or the base service alone?"

Per versus total

Per nail gives a unit charge; total includes all selected nails and the base service.

Each versus both

One on each hand equals two across both hands.

Subtotal

The art subtotal excludes the base price and is not the amount for the entire service.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

CONFIRM THE REDUCTION

"You are choosing two instead of the original four."

CHECK PLACEMENT

"Which two nails would you like decorated?"

AVOID SILENT ADDITIONS

"We will confirm any additional art before changing the price."

READ BACK THE TOTAL

"The agreed total is \$40."

CLARIFY BOTH HANDS

"Do you mean two in total across both hands?"

NAME THE FINGERS

"One ring fingernail on each hand gives two in total."

READ BACK THE DESIGN

"Simple line art on the two ring fingernails."

CONFIRM BEFORE STARTING

"Let us settle quantity, placement, and price before beginning."

Instead of

This marks an accepted change from four decorated nails to two.

Up to

A budget up to \$40 is a limit, not permission to exceed it with unmentioned additions.

Placement

Agreeing on two nails still leaves the specific fingers to be confirmed.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which quote is complete?

- A** Two decorated nails at \$10 plus the \$30 base: \$40 total.
- B** Two nails cost \$10, with the base omitted.
- C** Four nails cost \$40 including the base.
- D** Two nails on each hand cost \$40 total.

2. What does one ring fingernail on each hand mean?

- A** Every fingernail on both hands
- B** Two decorated nails in total
- C** Four decorated nails in total
- D** One decorated nail in total

3. Which response wrongly assumes agreement?

- A** The base service alone is \$30.
- B** Which two nails would you like decorated?
- C** I reduced your four-nail design without asking so the bill fits.
- D** Two decorated nails would total \$40.

4. Which change would exceed the accepted quantity?

- A** Leaving the other nails without this art
- B** Decorating two nails on each hand
- C** Decorating one ring fingernail per hand
- D** Keeping the art subtotal at \$10

Answers and explanations: [page 82](#).

Two accent nails within forty dollars

E Conversations / turns 1-10

04

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

both hands / quantity reduction / budget limit / complete quote / placement / base price / design approval / accent nail / art subtotal / per-nail charge

- 01 **Ben:** I would like the simple line design on four nails, but I need to keep the whole appointment at forty dollars. Does that work?
- 02 **Rosa:** Let me give you the ¹ _____ before we choose. The base service is thirty dollars, and simple line art is five dollars for each decorated nail.
- 03 **Ben:** I had thought five dollars meant the whole design, not five for every nail. What would the four-nail version come to?
- 04 **Rosa:** The ² _____ makes four decorated nails twenty dollars extra. Added to the thirty-dollar base service, that gives a total of fifty dollars.
- 05 **Ben:** That is more than I can spend today. Is there a smaller version that stays within forty without changing the base service?
- 06 **Rosa:** Two decorated nails would have an ³ _____ of ten dollars. With the base service, the complete total would be forty dollars.
- 07 **Ben:** And if I decide not to have any art at all, would the base service still be available at thirty?
- 08 **Rosa:** Yes. The ⁴ _____ is thirty dollars without the art. Your two choices within the limit are the base alone or the base with two decorated nails.
- 09 **Ben:** I would like the two decorated nails, then. I still want a small design, just not the original four-nail version.
- 10 **Rosa:** I will confirm that ⁵ _____ with you: two decorated nails instead of four, for forty dollars in total.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 37.

- 11 **Ben:** When you say two, is that two on each hand or two altogether? I want to make sure I am counting the same way.
- 12 **Rosa:** Two altogether, across ⁶ _____. Two on each hand would be four nails and would return the total to fifty dollars.
- 13 **Ben:** Then one on each hand sounds right. I would like the ring fingernails decorated, with the other nails left without that line design.
- 14 **Rosa:** That gives one ⁷ _____ on each hand. I will specify the two ring fingernails so the placement is not left to an assumption.
- 15 **Ben:** Please do. I care about which fingers have the design, not only how many there are. I do not want another pair selected for me.
- 16 **Rosa:** The ⁸ _____ is now clear: the ring fingernail on your left hand and the ring fingernail on your right.
- 17 **Ben:** Good. And forty is still the complete total, not forty plus another amount for selecting those fingers?
- 18 **Rosa:** Correct. Your ⁹ _____ is met by this option. There are no other charges in this comparison, and the two-nail art total remains ten dollars.
- 19 **Ben:** That is the option I agree to: the base service, simple line art on both ring fingernails, and forty dollars altogether.
- 20 **Rosa:** I have your ¹⁰ _____ for that exact option. We will confirm any later change before altering the quantity, placement, or price, rather than adding something without asking.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. complete quote | 2. per-nail charge | 3. art subtotal | 4. base price | 5. quantity reduction | 6. both hands | 7. accent nail | 8. placement | 9. budget limit | 10. design approval

Recalculate another art quote

F Say it

A base service costs \$35. Art costs \$4 per nail, with no other charges. The client has a \$43 limit and chooses one decorated nail on each hand.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

limit / eight / forty-three / two

Technician: "The selected quantity is ¹ _____ nails."

Client: "The art subtotal is ² _____ dollars."

Technician: "The complete total is ³ _____ dollars."

Client: "That total meets my budget ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 83

1. two | 2. eight | 3. forty-three | 4. limit

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Do not cover an unexplained concern

A Read the situation

Pause a cosmetic request, preserve the client report, and distinguish healthcare referral from salon service approval.

05

Before any service starts, client Elena reports unexplained tenderness beside one nail. Elena wants technician Dev to cover the area with product for an event. Dev pauses that request and recommends assessment by an appropriate healthcare professional without naming a condition or suggesting treatment. Elena agrees to seek appropriate advice. The salon must separately assess whether a cosmetic service is suitable. No product has been applied, no cause is established, and the healthcare referral does not guarantee that the salon will approve the requested service.

PEOPLE / Elena: Client | Dev: Nail technician

A CLEAR BOUNDARY CAN STILL BE KIND

Acknowledge why the event matters without making appearance more important than an unexplained concern. Use the client's own description, state what you cannot establish, and explain the next step calmly. A referral should not sound like either a diagnosis or a promise of later approval.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What does Elena report?

- | | |
|---|--|
| A A reaction after today's product application | B A completed cosmetic repair |
| C Unexplained tenderness beside one nail | D A confirmed medical diagnosis |

2. What happens to the covering request?

- | | |
|--|---------------------------------------|
| A Product is applied immediately | B It is approved after a guess |
| C It becomes a treatment prescription | D It is paused |

3. What does referral establish?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A A confirmed cause | B Permission to conceal the area |
| C A route to appropriate health assessment, not service approval | D A guarantee of a manicure |

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

tenderness

Reported soreness or sensitivity, particularly with touch or pressure.

IN USE report tenderness

nail fold

Skin bordering the nail plate.

IN USE identify the nail-fold area

adjacent skin

Skin beside the nail or another specified area.

IN USE describe adjacent skin

redness

Visible red appearance, if actually observed or reported.

IN USE record reported redness

swelling

Enlargement or puffiness, if actually observed or reported.

IN USE describe reported swelling

irritation

Uncomfortable response that should not be assigned a cause without assessment.

IN USE report possible irritation

allergic reaction

Health response requiring appropriate assessment, not a salon guess.

IN USE refer a suspected allergic reaction

sensitivity

Reported heightened response to touch or a substance.

IN USE clarify reported sensitivity

unexplained concern

Concern whose cause has not been established.

IN USE acknowledge an unexplained concern

symptom description

Client's words about what they experience.

IN USE preserve the symptom description

affected area

Specific location involved in the reported concern.

IN USE identify the affected area

onset

Time when the reported concern began.

IN USE clarify reported onset

Precision check

Tenderness is the reported concern, not a diagnosis. It was present before any service began. The request to cover it is paused, with no product applied. Refer the health question without naming a cause or recommending treatment.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

pre-existing concern

Concern present before the proposed service begins.

IN USE record a pre-existing concern

cosmetic request

Request to alter appearance, distinct from healthcare treatment.

IN USE pause the cosmetic request

covering product

Product proposed to conceal an area or change its appearance.

IN USE decline to apply a covering product

service pause

Temporary stop pending the appropriate next steps.

IN USE maintain the service pause

healthcare professional

Appropriately qualified person who assesses health concerns.

IN USE refer to a healthcare professional

referral

Direction to an appropriate professional or service for further assessment.

IN USE explain the referral

diagnosis

Identification of a health condition through appropriate clinical assessment.

IN USE avoid giving a diagnosis

treatment advice

Recommendation intended to address a health condition.

IN USE avoid unsupported treatment advice

cosmetic suitability

Whether the proposed cosmetic service is appropriate after assessment.

IN USE assess cosmetic suitability

service approval

Salon decision authorizing a specific service under its process.

IN USE distinguish service approval

event deadline

Client's preferred timing because of an upcoming event.

IN USE acknowledge the event deadline

factual note

Record limited to the reported or observed facts and agreed actions.

IN USE make a factual note

Precision check

Healthcare assessment and salon service approval answer different questions. A referral does not guarantee that a cosmetic service will be suitable or approved afterward. Keep the event deadline, health concern, and unapproved service request distinct.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE CONCERN

"Thank you for telling me about the tenderness."

STATE THE TIMING

"This was reported before any service began."

AVOID A DIAGNOSIS

"I cannot determine what is causing the tenderness."

AVOID TREATMENT ADVICE

"I cannot recommend a treatment for an unexplained health concern."

CLARIFY THE LOCATION

"You are describing the area beside this nail."

PAUSE THE REQUEST

"I will pause the request to cover that area with product."

REFER APPROPRIATELY

"Please have the concern assessed by an appropriate healthcare professional."

ACKNOWLEDGE THE EVENT

"I understand why you wanted a cosmetic result for the event."

Beside versus on

Beside locates the concern next to the nail rather than automatically on the nail plate.

Reported versus diagnosed

A client report supplies information but does not identify a medical condition.

Before

The sequence prevents the record from incorrectly attributing the concern to today's service.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP THE BOUNDARY

"The event does not establish that applying product is suitable."

SEPARATE THE DECISIONS

"The salon must assess cosmetic suitability separately."

PRESERVE THE CLIENT'S WORDS

"I will record tenderness beside one nail, without adding a condition name."

KEEP THE REQUEST PENDING

"The cosmetic request remains paused."

STATE WHAT HAS NOT HAPPENED

"No product has been applied."

AVOID A FUTURE GUARANTEE

"The referral does not guarantee service approval afterward."

CONFIRM THE NEXT STEP

"You will seek appropriate healthcare advice about the concern."

CLOSE FACTUALLY

"No cause is established and no covering service is approved."

Pause versus treat

Pausing a request does not provide treatment for the underlying concern.

Referral versus clearance

Referral seeks appropriate assessment and does not itself approve a cosmetic service.

Event pressure

A deadline explains the client's preference but does not replace suitability assessment.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which note stays factual?

- A** Today's product caused the condition.
- B** Product applied to solve the concern.
- C** Tenderness beside one nail reported before service; covering request paused.
- D** Infection confirmed by the technician.

2. Which response overpromises?

- A** The cause has not been established.
- B** After the referral, we will definitely perform the requested service.
- C** The cosmetic request remains paused.
- D** No product has been applied.

3. Which next step addresses the health question?

- A** Guessing from an unrelated photograph
- B** Assessment by an appropriate healthcare professional
- C** Covering the area for the event
- D** Selecting a color to conceal it

4. Which distinction matters?

- A** A referral is a treatment prescription.
- B** Healthcare assessment and cosmetic-service suitability are separate decisions.
- C** A client deadline equals service approval.
- D** Tenderness always identifies one condition.

Answers and explanations: [page 84](#).

Do not cover an unexplained concern

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

05

WORD + PHRASE BANK

diagnosis / healthcare professional / service approval / pause / tenderness / event deadline / factual note / referral / Cosmetic suitability / pre-existing concern

- 01 **Elena:** Before we start, I should mention that the area beside this nail is tender. Could you cover it with product so it looks better for my event?
- 02 **Dev:** Thank you for telling me. I will ¹ _____ that request for now. The tenderness needs appropriate attention before we make assumptions about a cosmetic service.
- 03 **Elena:** I do not know what caused it. I was hoping the appointment could still go ahead because the event is important to me.
- 04 **Dev:** I understand the ² _____. It matters to your plans, but it does not tell us whether applying product to the area is suitable.
- 05 **Elena:** I am not asking you to name a condition. I just want to be sure you have understood where I feel it.
- 06 **Dev:** You are reporting ³ _____ beside this nail. I will keep that description rather than add a condition name or assume a cause.
- 07 **Elena:** Yes. It was there before I arrived, and nothing from today's appointment has been put on it.
- 08 **Dev:** I will record it as a ⁴ _____. No product has been applied today, and no service has started.
- 09 **Elena:** Who should I ask about the tenderness, then? I do not want to rely on a guess from someone who has not assessed it.
- 10 **Dev:** Please have the concern assessed by an appropriate ⁵ _____. I cannot determine the cause or recommend treatment from this salon conversation.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 46.

- 11 **Elena:** All right. Does asking for that assessment mean the salon will definitely do the service afterward, once I have spoken to someone?
- 12 **Dev:** No. The ⁶ _____ does not guarantee that. The salon must separately decide whether the proposed cosmetic service is suitable through its normal process.
- 13 **Elena:** So there are two different questions: what the tenderness means, and whether the cosmetic service I requested is appropriate.
- 14 **Dev:** Exactly. ⁷ _____ is not established simply by making a referral. We should not promise approval before the relevant decisions have been made.
- 15 **Elena:** I understand. Please do not put a medical label in the note. I have not been told what it is, and I do not want that guessed.
- 16 **Dev:** I will make a ⁸ _____ with your description, the fact that it was reported before service, and the request to cover it being paused.
- 17 **Elena:** That is accurate. I will seek appropriate healthcare advice, and I understand that you are not suggesting a treatment here.
- 18 **Dev:** Correct. I am not giving a ⁹ _____ or treatment advice. The immediate salon decision is not to apply a covering product to this unexplained concern.
- 19 **Elena:** Thank you for explaining it without dismissing the event. I would rather know the limits clearly than leave with an assumption about what has been approved.
- 20 **Dev:** The ¹⁰ _____ remains unresolved. No cause is established, no product has been applied, and the cosmetic request stays paused while you seek the appropriate advice.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. pause | 2. event deadline | 3. tenderness | 4. pre-existing concern | 5. healthcare professional | 6. referral | 7. Cosmetic suitability | 8. factual note | 9. diagnosis | 10. service approval

Separate referral from service approval

F Say it

Before service, a client reports unexplained soreness beside one nail. No product is applied. The covering request is paused, and the client is directed to an appropriate healthcare professional. Salon suitability remains unassessed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

unassessed / paused / applied / soreness

Technician: "The reported concern is ¹ _____ beside one nail."

Client: "No product has been ² _____."

Technician: "The covering request remains ³ _____."

Reception: "Cosmetic suitability is still ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 85

1. soreness | 2. applied | 3. paused | 4. unassessed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Tidy is not confirmed ready

A Read the situation

Distinguish visible tidiness from completed readiness checks and offer a verified alternative without inventing a release time.

Receptionist Maya needs a station for a waiting client. Technician Owen reports that station three looks tidy but its required readiness checks are incomplete. Responsible technician Rosa has confirmed station two ready. Owen offers station two and keeps station three marked pending until its actual checks are completed and readiness is confirmed through the salon process. No completion time for station three is known. This is a communication task, not a set of cleaning, disinfection, equipment, or chemical-use instructions.

PEOPLE / Maya: Receptionist | Owen: Nail technician

06

USE STATUS WORDS COLLEAGUES CAN ACT ON

Tidy, nearly done, and should be fine may sound reassuring while leaving an essential check unclear. Give the specific station, verified status, and available next step. A waiting client creates a scheduling need, not evidence that unfinished checks can be treated as complete.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. Which station is confirmed ready?

A Both stations

B Neither station

C Station two

D Station three

2. What is station three's status?

A Already in use with approval

B Tidy, with required checks incomplete

C Confirmed ready because it looks tidy

D Permanently closed

3. What time will station three be ready?

A Before the client sits down

B It was ready earlier

C No completion time is known

D Exactly five minutes from now

Answers and explanations: page 86.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

station

Designated work area for a client service.

IN USE identify the station

readiness check

Required review before a station is confirmed available for use.

IN USE complete a readiness check

confirmed ready

Status supported by the responsible person's completed process.

IN USE report confirmed-ready status

pending status

State of waiting for an unfinished check or decision.

IN USE keep the pending status

tidiness

Visible orderliness, not proof of completed hygiene or readiness checks.

IN USE distinguish tidiness from readiness

cleaning

Removal of dirt or material, distinct from every further required process.

IN USE distinguish cleaning from disinfection

disinfection

Process intended to control specified microorganisms under applicable instructions.

IN USE refer to disinfection requirements

single-use item

Item intended for one use under its instructions.

IN USE identify a single-use item

reusable implement

Tool intended for repeated use subject to the required processing.

IN USE identify a reusable implement

service tray

Surface or container holding items for a service.

IN USE identify the service tray

work surface

Surface used during the service.

IN USE check work-surface status

clean storage

Designated storage for appropriately prepared items.

IN USE identify clean storage

Precision check

Station three is tidy but not confirmed ready because required checks are incomplete. Station two is confirmed ready by Rosa. Offer the verified alternative without silently upgrading station three or inventing a completion time.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

used-item area

Designated place for items awaiting the required handling.

IN USE identify the used-item area

waste container

Receptacle for waste under the applicable procedure.

IN USE check the waste container

product label

Product information including identity, instructions, and warnings.

IN USE consult the product label

safety data sheet

Document describing a product's hazards and relevant safety information.

IN USE locate the safety data sheet

ventilation

Movement or exchange of air through the relevant workplace system.

IN USE report a ventilation concern

local exhaust

System capturing airborne material near its source.

IN USE identify local exhaust

personal protective equipment

Equipment used to reduce exposure to workplace hazards.

IN USE confirm required personal protective equipment

check record

Record showing what has been checked and its status.

IN USE update the check record

responsible technician

Person accountable for the relevant station confirmation.

IN USE name the responsible technician

release confirmation

Statement that the station has met the required readiness process.

IN USE await release confirmation

available alternative

Verified option that can be offered now.

IN USE offer the available alternative

readiness handover

Transfer of accurate station status to the next colleague.

IN USE give a readiness handover

Precision check

Cleaning, disinfection, storage, product information, and equipment terms describe different parts of real workplace systems. This lesson does not supply procedures or authorize a shortcut. Use actual instructions, training, and the responsible confirmation process.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

IDENTIFY THE STATION

"Station three is the one still awaiting checks."

AVOID AN APPEARANCE SHORTCUT

"Tidiness does not establish confirmed readiness."

NAME THE CONFIRMATION SOURCE

"Rosa is the responsible technician who confirmed it."

KEEP THE PENDING STATUS

"Station three should remain marked pending."

DESCRIBE ONLY WHAT IS KNOWN

"It looks tidy, but its required checks are incomplete."

STATE THE VERIFIED ALTERNATIVE

"Station two has been confirmed ready."

OFFER A WORKABLE NEXT STEP

"We can offer the client station two."

AVOID A GUESSED TIME

"I do not have a confirmed completion time for station three."

06

Tidy versus ready

Visible order does not prove that all required checks are complete.

Two versus three

Read back the station numbers to prevent a correct status attaching to the wrong place.

Confirmed by

Names the responsible source rather than implying personal observation of every check.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE WAIT

"I know the client is waiting; we have a verified alternative."

KEEP PROCEDURES SEPARATE

"The checks must follow the actual salon process."

READ BACK THE NUMBERS

"Two is confirmed ready; three is pending."

GIVE A CLIENT-FACING MESSAGE

"A confirmed-ready station is available for you."

ASK A PRECISE QUESTION

"Which station has completed the required readiness process?"

PREVENT AN INACCURATE UPDATE

"Please do not change three to ready because the surface looks clear."

CONFIRM THE NEXT UPDATE

"We will update three after the required confirmation."

CLOSE THE HANDOVER

"Use the verified status, not an estimate based on appearance."

06

Pending

This means unfinished, not failed forever or ready for immediate use.

Available alternative

An actual ready station gives a useful option without pressuring an incomplete one.

No completion time

An unknown time should remain unknown until a reliable update is available.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handover is accurate?

- A** Three ready and two awaiting review.
- B** Three ready in five minutes without a source.
- C** Two confirmed ready by Rosa; three tidy with checks incomplete.
- D** Both ready because the room looks neat.

2. Which message should reception give the client?

- A** Station three will definitely be ready immediately.
- B** A confirmed-ready station is available at station two.
- C** Station three is ready because its table is empty.
- D** All checks are optional when someone is waiting.

3. What would justify updating station three's status?

- A** Completion of its required checks and the actual readiness confirmation
- B** A shorter queue
- C** A tidy appearance alone
- D** A client's willingness to sit there

4. Which question is most precise?

- A** Are we usually quick?
- B** Can the client wait quietly?
- C** Has station three received the required readiness confirmation?
- D** Does everything seem fine?

Answers and explanations: [page 86](#).

Tidy is not confirmed ready

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

available alternative / release confirmation / confirmed ready / readiness handover / completion time / client-facing message / tidy / responsible technician / pending status / read-back

06

- 01 **Maya:** I have a client waiting. Station three looks clear from reception, so I wanted to check whether I can direct the client there.
- 02 **Owen:** Station three is ¹ _____, but its required readiness checks are not complete. Please do not treat the clear surface as confirmation that the station is ready.
- 03 **Maya:** Thank you for checking. I do not want to send someone to the wrong place just because it looks finished from a distance.
- 04 **Owen:** There is an ² _____: station two. Rosa has confirmed that station ready, so we can offer it without waiting for three.
- 05 **Maya:** Let me make sure I heard the numbers correctly. Two is ready, and three is still waiting for the remaining checks.
- 06 **Owen:** Correct. Two is ³ _____ by Rosa. Three has incomplete checks and should remain pending, even though it looks orderly.
- 07 **Maya:** Do we have an estimate for three? The next person may ask how long it will be before that station is available.
- 08 **Owen:** I do not have a verified ⁴ _____. I would rather leave the time open than turn an unconfirmed guess into a promise to the next client.
- 09 **Maya:** That is sensible. For the client already here, I can offer station two and avoid giving a waiting estimate for three.
- 10 **Owen:** Yes. Use the ⁵ _____ as it stands: two is ready, three is pending. The actual checks for three still follow our salon process.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 55.

- 11 **Maya:** The display currently has three marked almost ready. That might encourage someone to seat the client there while the checks are still unfinished.
- 12 **Owen:** Please keep its ⁶ _____ clear. Almost ready should not be read as permission to start a service there.
- 13 **Maya:** Who should be named as the source for station two's confirmation? I want the update to be traceable if another colleague asks.
- 14 **Owen:** Rosa is the ⁷ _____ who confirmed station two. Naming the source is more useful than simply saying somebody said it was fine.
- 15 **Maya:** And station three should not change to ready until its checks are complete and the responsible confirmation has actually been given.
- 16 **Owen:** Exactly. We need the ⁸ _____ through the salon process. A tidy station and a waiting client do not replace that step.
- 17 **Maya:** I will offer two now. For the client, I can simply say that a confirmed-ready station is available, without describing technical procedures.
- 18 **Owen:** That is a clear ⁹ _____. The client needs an accurate next step, while the internal record preserves which checks are still unfinished elsewhere.
- 19 **Maya:** I have it: station two confirmed ready by Rosa, station three pending, and no confirmed completion time for three.
- 20 **Owen:** That ¹⁰ _____ is accurate. We will update station three when its required confirmation is available, and we will not let its appearance stand in for the actual status.

06

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. tidy | 2. available alternative | 3. confirmed ready | 4. completion time | 5. readiness handover | 6. pending status | 7. responsible technician | 8. release confirmation | 9. client-facing message | 10. read-back

Read back different station numbers

F Say it

Station five is tidy but has incomplete required checks. Station one is confirmed ready by technician Jo. No completion time is known for five. A waiting client can be offered one.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

06

WORD + PHRASE BANK

pending / time / Jo / one

Reception: "The verified alternative is station ¹ _____."

Technician: "Station five remains ² _____."

Reception: "The confirming technician for one is ³ _____."

Technician: "Five has no confirmed completion ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 87

1. one | 2. pending | 3. Jo | 4. time

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

The lettering faces the wrong way

A Read the situation

Acknowledge a documented design-direction mismatch and offer a review without promising an unassessed correction.

Client Imani contacts receptionist Alex because the line-art lettering on the finished nails faces away from the client. Imani requested lettering facing toward the client, and the service record confirms that original direction. A review with technician Rosa is available today at 4:00 with no review fee. Imani accepts that review. No correction method, correction price, refund, or completion time has been assessed or approved. Alex must recognize the documented mismatch without claiming that the no-fee review guarantees a free or immediate particular correction.

PEOPLE / Imani: Client | Alex: Receptionist

07

A SPECIFIC ACKNOWLEDGMENT PREVENTS A CIRCULAR COMPLAINT

When the record confirms a requested detail, acknowledge it directly rather than asking the client to defend the same preference repeatedly. Then separate the review arrangement from any remedy that still needs assessment. Clear limits are more useful than a vague promise to make everything right.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What direction was requested and recorded?

- A No direction was discussed
- C Lettering facing toward the client

- B A direction chosen later by reception
- D Lettering facing away from the client

2. What is available today?

- A A guaranteed full correction at 4:00
- C A completed replacement design

- B An approved refund at 4:00
- D A no-fee review at 4:00

3. What does no review fee mean?

- A Every possible correction is free
- C A refund has already been paid

- B Every future service is free
- D The review itself has no charge

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

design concern

Client's issue with an aspect of the finished decoration.

IN USE acknowledge a design concern

lettering

Letters used as part of the nail-art design.

IN USE check the lettering

facing toward

Oriented so the relevant front faces the named viewer.

IN USE confirm lettering facing toward the client

facing away

Oriented in the opposite direction from the named viewer.

IN USE report lettering facing away

orientation mismatch

Difference between the agreed and delivered direction.

IN USE acknowledge an orientation mismatch

viewing perspective

Position from which the design is meant to be read.

IN USE clarify the viewing perspective

legibility

Ease of reading the lettering.

IN USE discuss legibility

design brief

Agreed description of the requested decoration.

IN USE refer to the design brief

service record

Record of the original request and service details.

IN USE check the service record

documented request

Preference supported by the existing record.

IN USE acknowledge the documented request

finished result

Appearance after the service has been performed.

IN USE review the finished result

chip

Small area of product or coating that has broken away.

IN USE report a chip

Precision check

The record supports the original toward-client direction, while the client reports that the finished lettering faces away. Acknowledge that mismatch specifically. The accepted 4:00 appointment is a review, not a promised correction.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

lifting

Separation of enhancement material from the nail surface.

IN USE report lifting

wear concern

Report about how the result has changed during use.

IN USE record a wear concern

review appointment

Meeting to examine a concern before deciding a response.

IN USE confirm the review appointment

review fee

Charge for the assessment appointment itself.

IN USE clarify the review fee

correction method

Proposed way of addressing an assessed design issue.

IN USE assess the correction method

correction estimate

Provisional price or time for a proposed remedy.

IN USE provide a correction estimate

remedy decision

Decision about what response is appropriate.

IN USE separate the remedy decision

refund approval

Authorized decision to return money.

IN USE distinguish refund approval

completion promise

Commitment about when work will be finished.

IN USE avoid an unsupported completion promise

specific acknowledgment

Recognition of the exact issue rather than a generic apology.

IN USE give a specific acknowledgment

case note

Factual record of the concern and agreed next step.

IN USE update the case note

review confirmation

Agreement on the time and purpose of the review.

IN USE send the review confirmation

Precision check

No review fee applies to the assessment itself. The case does not establish any correction method, charge, refund, or finish time. Do not expand a limited fee statement into a guarantee about every possible remedy.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

ACKNOWLEDGE THE DETAIL

"You requested the lettering facing toward you."

DESCRIBE THE CONCERN

"You are reporting that the finished lettering faces away."

OFFER THE REVIEW

"Rosa can review the concern today at 4:00."

SEPARATE REVIEW FROM REMEDY

"The correction needs assessment before we promise a method."

USE THE RECORD

"The service record confirms that direction."

AVOID AN ARGUMENT OVER PREFERENCE

"We do not need to treat the recorded direction as a new request."

STATE THE LIMITED FEE FACT

"There is no fee for that review."

AVOID EXPANDING THE FEE STATEMENT

"No review fee does not establish the price of unassessed further work."

Toward versus away

These words reverse the meaning, so name the viewer as well as the direction.

Recorded versus newly requested

The record supports an original preference, not a later change of mind.

Review versus correction

One examines the concern; the other performs additional work.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP REFUND STATUS CLEAR

"No refund has been approved."

ASK FOR ACCEPTANCE

"Would you like the 4:00 review?"

PRESERVE THE ORIENTATION

"I will record toward you as the original request."

READ BACK THE ARRANGEMENT

"Today at 4:00 with Rosa, for a no-fee review."

AVOID A FINISH-TIME PROMISE

"We have not established when any correction could be completed."

CONFIRM THE PURPOSE

"The appointment is to examine the design-direction concern."

KEEP THE REPORT PRECISE

"This concern is about direction, not a reported chip."

CLOSE WITH THE NEXT STEP

"We will discuss any proposed remedy after the review."

No fee for

The phrase limits the no-charge statement to the named activity.

Available versus accepted

The review becomes the agreed arrangement after the client chooses it.

Concern type

Direction, chipping, and lifting are different reports and should not be substituted for one another.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which acknowledgment matches the record?

- A** You requested lettering facing toward you, and that direction is recorded.
- B** You never specified a direction.
- C** You requested lettering facing away.
- D** You are changing the original design brief.

2. Which promise exceeds the supplied facts?

- A** No refund has been approved.
- B** Every correction will be free and completed during the review.
- C** The review has no fee.
- D** Rosa is available at 4:00.

3. Which concern should the case note identify?

- A** A lettering-orientation mismatch
- B** A confirmed product allergy
- C** A reported chip that was never mentioned
- D** A guaranteed removal procedure

4. Which confirmation is accurate after acceptance?

- A** Today at 4:00 with Rosa for a no-fee review of the direction concern.
- B** A full correction at 4:00 with every cost waived.
- C** A refund already processed.
- D** A new paid design unrelated to the original record.

Answers and explanations: [page 88](#).

The lettering faces the wrong way

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

orientation mismatch / service record / case note / review confirmation / completion promise / viewing perspective / review appointment / remedy decision / correction method / review fee

07

- 01 **Imani:** I am calling about the lettering on my nails. I asked for it to face toward me, but the finished lettering faces away from me.
- 02 **Alex:** I have checked the ¹ _____, and it confirms the direction you requested. You wanted the lettering facing toward you.
- 03 **Imani:** Yes. I wanted to be able to read it from my own viewpoint. I do not want that described as changing my mind after the appointment.
- 04 **Alex:** I understand. This is an ² _____ against the recorded request, not simply a new direction you have decided on afterward.
- 05 **Imani:** Thank you. I would like someone to look at it, but I need to know whether you can offer a time today.
- 06 **Alex:** Rosa has a ³ _____ available at four today. The purpose is to examine the design concern and discuss the appropriate next step.
- 07 **Imani:** Is there a charge just to come in and have that review? I want to understand that before I agree to the appointment.
- 08 **Alex:** There is no ⁴ _____ for this appointment. I want to keep that clear and separate from any additional work that has not yet been assessed.
- 09 **Imani:** Does that mean you are not promising a particular correction before Rosa sees it? I would rather hear an accurate answer now.
- 10 **Alex:** Correct. The ⁵ _____ needs assessment. I cannot tell you that one particular change will be made before Rosa has reviewed the result with you.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

07

Continue with the word bank on page 64.

- 11 **Imani:** That is fine. I do not want more work started without an explanation of what is proposed and what it would involve.
- 12 **Alex:** Any ⁶ _____ should follow that discussion. Accepting a review is not the same as agreeing in advance to whatever further work might be suggested.
- 13 **Imani:** Could you also avoid promising that I will leave with it corrected at a certain time? I may need to plan another commitment.
- 14 **Alex:** We have not established a ⁷ _____ for any correction. Four o'clock is the review time, not a guaranteed finishing time for additional work.
- 15 **Imani:** All right. I will take the review at four with Rosa. Please make sure the note explains the direction rather than just saying nail problem.
- 16 **Alex:** I will make a specific ⁸ _____: lettering requested toward you, recorded that way, but reported as facing away in the finished result.
- 17 **Imani:** Exactly. It is not a chip or a problem I am reporting about wear. It is the direction of the lettering.
- 18 **Alex:** That ⁹ _____ is central to the report. I will not replace it with a different issue or say that a cause, refund, or correction has already been settled.
- 19 **Imani:** Thank you. The review time and the fact that the review itself has no fee are the two things I needed confirmed today.
- 20 **Alex:** Your ¹⁰ _____ is today at four with Rosa, with no fee for the review. Any proposed further work will be discussed after assessment rather than promised during this booking call.

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. service record | 2. orientation mismatch | 3. review appointment | 4. review fee | 5. correction method | 6. remedy decision | 7. completion promise | 8. case note | 9. viewing perspective | 10. review confirmation

Confirm a different design review

F Say it

The record says lettering should face away from the client, but the client reports it faces toward them. A no-fee review with Jo tomorrow at 11:00 is accepted. No correction method or price is agreed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

07

WORD + PHRASE BANK

agreed / away / fee / 11:00

Reception: "The recorded direction is ¹ _____ from the client."

Client: "The accepted review is tomorrow at ² _____."

Reception: "The review itself has no ³ _____."

Reception: "No correction method is ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 89

1. away | 2. 11:00 | 3. fee | 4. agreed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

Friday is a request, not a booking

A Read the situation

Hand over the desired appearance, unknown existing product, and pending consultation without inventing removal time or an infill booking.

Technician Sora hands a client request to receptionist Malik. The client wants plain color next Friday at 10:00 and declines nail art. An existing product is present, but its identity is unknown. Reception must arrange a consultation before confirming removal duration or whether an infill is appropriate. Friday at 10:00 is only a requested time; no appointment has been accepted or booked. Malik takes responsibility for discussing consultation availability while keeping the product uncertainty and no-art preference explicit.

PEOPLE / Sora: Nail technician | Malik: Receptionist

08

DO NOT LET A CONVENIENT SLOT DECIDE THE SERVICE

A client may ask for a familiar time before the existing product or needed service is understood. Record the requested time without treating it as a confirmed slot. An accurate handover keeps the next colleague from promising a duration or infill based on an unidentified product.

Briefing checks

Circle one answer in each item. Use the briefing.

1. What appearance does the client request?

- | | |
|---------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| A Plain color with no nail art | B Four decorated nails |
| C A confirmed extension design | D A specific removal method |

2. What is unknown?

- | | |
|---|---|
| A Whether any product is present | B The requested day and time |
| C The no-art preference | D The identity of the existing product |

3. What is Friday at 10:00?

- | | |
|---|-------------------------------------|
| A A guaranteed removal completion time | B A confirmed infill service |
| C A requested time, not a booking | D An accepted appointment |

Answers and explanations: page 90.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 1 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

existing product

Material already on the client's nails before a new service.

IN USE identify the existing product

product identity

Exact identifying information about the material present.

IN USE confirm product identity

unidentified product

Existing material whose type or identity is not established.

IN USE record an unidentified product

service history

Relevant record of earlier nail services and products.

IN USE review service history

previous provider

Professional or salon that performed an earlier service.

IN USE clarify the previous provider

removal consultation

Discussion and assessment before confirming a removal service.

IN USE arrange a removal consultation

removal duration

Time needed for removing an identified product under the actual process.

IN USE assess removal duration

soak-off

Product-removal category used for materials designed for the relevant solvent process.

IN USE clarify a soak-off category

file-off

Product-removal category involving controlled filing under professional procedures.

IN USE distinguish a file-off category

infill

Maintenance service addressing growth in an existing enhancement when appropriate.

IN USE assess whether an infill is suitable

rebalance

Maintenance term for restoring enhancement structure as the nail grows.

IN USE discuss rebalance terminology

regrowth area

New growth visible near the base of an existing enhancement.

IN USE identify the regrowth area

Precision check

The client wants plain color, no nail art, and Friday at 10:00. Those are a preference and a requested time, not a booking. The unidentified existing product means removal duration and infill suitability cannot be confirmed from the supplied facts.

The vocabulary that does the work

B Find the words / 2 of 2

Read the definitions and say the common word combinations aloud.

maintenance appointment

Follow-up service whose scope depends on assessment.

IN USE clarify the maintenance appointment

plain-color request

Preference for color without added decorative art.

IN USE preserve the plain-color request

declined option

Service element the client has explicitly not selected.

IN USE record the declined option

requested time

Preferred slot that has not necessarily been offered or accepted.

IN USE record the requested time

confirmed appointment

Booking with the relevant details agreed.

IN USE distinguish a confirmed appointment

availability discussion

Conversation about possible times, not automatic acceptance.

IN USE hold an availability discussion

consultation prerequisite

Consultation needed before confirming further service details.

IN USE explain the consultation prerequisite

provisional duration

Tentative time estimate not yet a firm service allocation.

IN USE avoid an unsupported provisional duration

handover owner

Person responsible for the next action after the handover.

IN USE name the handover owner

client confirmation

Explicit acceptance of the relevant appointment or service details.

IN USE obtain client confirmation

pending action

Next step that remains unfinished.

IN USE identify the pending action

status correction

Amendment replacing an inaccurate status with the true one.

IN USE make a status correction

08

Precision check

Soak-off, file-off, infill, and rebalance are not interchangeable booking labels. This lesson provides no removal instructions. The consultation must establish the actual product and appropriate service before reception promises a duration or confirms an infill.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 1 of 2

OPEN THE HANDOVER

"I have a plain-color request with an unidentified existing product."

RECORD THE REQUESTED SLOT

"Friday at 10:00 is the preferred time."

NAME THE UNCERTAINTY

"We do not yet know which product is present."

EXPLAIN THE PREREQUISITE

"A consultation is needed before confirming removal time."

STATE THE APPEARANCE

"The client wants plain color and no nail art."

PREVENT A BOOKING ASSUMPTION

"That time is requested, not booked."

KEEP HISTORY ACCURATE

"Unknown product does not mean no existing product."

AVOID A STANDARD-TIME GUESS

"I cannot assign a removal duration from the current information."

08

Unknown versus absent

The product is present but unidentified; do not erase it from the history.

Requested versus confirmed

A preferred time becomes a booking only through the actual confirmation process.

Before

Consultation is a prerequisite to confirming the unassessed service details.

Phrases you can actually use

C Notice the language / 2 of 2

KEEP INFILL OPEN

"Whether an infill is appropriate still needs assessment."

ASSIGN THE NEXT ACTION

"Reception will discuss consultation availability."

PRESERVE THE DECLINED OPTION

"Please keep no nail art explicit in the record."

CORRECT THE STATUS

"Change confirmed to requested if that entry was made prematurely."

SEPARATE SERVICE CATEGORIES

"Removal and infill are not the same booking decision."

AVOID INVENTING ACCEPTANCE

"No appointment date has been accepted yet."

ASK FOR A READ-BACK

"Can you repeat the request and the unresolved details?"

CLOSE THE HANDOVER

"Consultation pending; removal time and infill unconfirmed."

08

Removal versus infill

One removes material; the other maintains an existing enhancement when suitable.

No nail art

This is an explicit exclusion, not an invitation to choose a simpler design silently.

Owner versus completion

Reception accepting the next action does not mean the consultation has occurred.

Choose the precise message

D Check your understanding

Circle one best answer for each item. Use the stated purpose and case facts, not the option that merely sounds most polite.

1. Which handover is accurate?

- A** No existing product because its name is unknown.
- B** Nail art approved during reception handover.
- C** Plain color, no art, Friday 10:00 requested; existing product unidentified.
- D** Infill booked Friday with standard removal time.

2. What must precede confirmation of removal time?

- A** Assuming every product removes identically
- B** Selecting the shortest available slot
- C** Treating Friday as already booked
- D** The consultation needed to assess the existing product and service

3. Which phrase makes an unsupported commitment?

- A** No nail art is requested.
- B** Your infill is confirmed for Friday at ten.
- C** Friday at ten is your requested time.
- D** Reception will discuss consultation availability.

4. What does reception taking responsibility mean?

- A** Removal duration is automatically confirmed.
- B** Reception owns the next availability discussion.
- C** Consultation has already been completed.
- D** Existing product is now identified.

Answers and explanations: page 90.

Friday is a request, not a booking

E Conversations / turns 1-10

Complete the numbered gaps. Use each bank entry once, without changing its form. Cover the answers at the end until you finish.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

consultation prerequisite / declined option / handover owner / client confirmation / pending action / infill / requested time / plain-color request / unidentified product / removal duration

08

- 01 **Sora:** I need to hand over a follow-up request. The client wants plain color next Friday at ten, but there is an existing product we have not identified.
- 02 **Malik:** I will separate the ¹ _____ from the service assessment. Is nail art wanted, or should the record explicitly say that it has been declined?
- 03 **Sora:** Please say no nail art. The client was clear about that, and I do not want a small design added just because someone thinks it would be suitable.
- 04 **Malik:** I will preserve that ² _____. Plain color and no nail art should remain together in the appearance note.
- 05 **Sora:** Thank you. Friday at ten is the time the client requested, but we did not offer a confirmed appointment or get acceptance of a slot.
- 06 **Malik:** Then the ³ _____ stays requested. I will not enter it as a booking just because the client named a day and an hour.
- 07 **Sora:** Exactly. We also cannot assume what removal involves. The client says there is product on the nails but cannot identify it.
- 08 **Malik:** I will record an ⁴ _____, not no product. That distinction matters before anyone promises a standard removal time.
- 09 **Sora:** Reception needs to arrange a consultation first. We should not choose a short slot and then make the service description fit that time.
- 10 **Malik:** The ⁵ _____ is clear. I will discuss consultation availability rather than confirm an unassessed removal or infill service.

The conversation, continued

E Conversations / turns 11-20

Continue with the word bank on page 73.

- 11 **Sora:** Good. The client may use infill as a general word for the next visit, but we have not established whether that is appropriate here.
- 12 **Malik:** An ⁶ _____ is not automatically the right booking just because it is a familiar term. Its suitability still needs assessment through the consultation.
- 13 **Sora:** And removal time remains unconfirmed. Please do not give a number based on what another client's service happened to take.
- 14 **Malik:** I will leave ⁷ _____ unconfirmed. The product and relevant service need to be understood before a meaningful time allocation is promised.
- 15 **Sora:** Could you read back the handover now? I want to catch any wording that makes the Friday preference sound more definite than it is.
- 16 **Malik:** Plain color, no nail art, Friday at ten requested but unbooked, and existing product unidentified. The ⁸ _____ is to discuss a consultation before confirming removal time or infill suitability.
- 17 **Sora:** That is accurate. Reception will handle that next discussion and ask the client to confirm any actual appointment offered.
- 18 **Malik:** I will be the ⁹ _____ for the availability discussion. Taking responsibility does not change the unbooked status or resolve the product uncertainty.
- 19 **Sora:** Perfect. Please keep the client informed about what the consultation is for, so it does not sound as though we are refusing to discuss the request.
- 20 **Malik:** I will explain the purpose and seek ¹⁰ _____ for any offered slot. The record will remain precise: request received, consultation pending, and no removal duration or infill booking confirmed.

08

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. plain-color request | 2. declined option | 3. requested time | 4. unidentified product | 5. consultation prerequisite | 6. infill | 7. removal duration | 8. pending action | 9. handover owner | 10. client confirmation

Hand over another unbooked request

F Say it

A client requests plain color on Tuesday at 2:00, with no nail art. Existing product is unidentified. Reception owns the consultation availability discussion before removal time or infill suitability can be confirmed.

Complete the four gaps. Use each bank entry once.

WORD + PHRASE BANK

reception / unidentified / confirmed / Tuesday

Technician: "The requested day is ¹ _____."

Reception: "Existing product remains ² _____."

Technician: "The next availability discussion belongs to ³ _____."

Reception: "Removal time cannot yet be ⁴ _____."

ANSWERS / EXPLANATIONS: PAGE 91

1. Tuesday | 2. unidentified | 3. reception | 4. confirmed

Rehearse with a fixed script

1. Check your answers, then read turns 1-10 with a partner using the corrected words.
2. Switch roles for turns 11-20. Stress words that distinguish facts from conditions or estimates.
3. Complete and check the four-line exchange. Read it twice, switching roles and keeping the printed facts.

WORKING ALONE

Read both roles, pausing for two seconds when the speaker changes. Repeat with the bank covered, then check any missed expressions.

01 Briefing and language checks

Clarifying the service and the intended length

A Briefing checks / page 4

1. What length does Zoe want?

B. The current short length retained

Zoe explicitly wants the existing short length rather than the long reference.

2. What was booked?

B. An overlay

The booking says overlay even though Zoe uses another label in conversation.

3. What does the reference image authorize by itself?

D. No automatic length change

An image starts the discussion but does not replace explicit agreement about length.

D Language checks / page 9

1. Which question resolves the key ambiguity?

B. Do you want added length, or your current short length kept?

The question directly checks the client's actual length preference rather than assuming the label.

2. Which summary is accurate?

B. Natural-nail overlay discussion at current short length, with no extensions requested.

The summary preserves the clarified length and leaves other service decisions open.

3. Which product statement is supported?

D. Product selection still needs clarification.

The case does not select a system or bypass the normal consultation.

4. Which response avoids blaming the client for terminology?

C. Service names vary; let us confirm the result you want.

The response invites clarification respectfully instead of treating vocabulary knowledge as a prerequisite.

01 Conversation answers

Clarifying the service and the intended length

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 10-11

- 1. overlay.** Turn 2. Overlay is the booked service label, which needs clarification rather than being treated as automatic permission for extensions.
- 2. service label.** Turn 4. Service label is the name used for the appointment; the desired result matters more than assuming the client uses it with one technical meaning.
- 3. reference image.** Turn 6. Reference image supplies visual ideas for discussion, not permission to copy the length or every other feature.
- 4. extensions.** Turn 8. Extensions would add length beyond the existing natural nail; Zoe has explicitly said that is not the current request.
- 5. natural-nail overlay.** Turn 10. Natural-nail overlay specifies a coating over the existing nail in this request, without automatically adding length or choosing the material.
- 6. product categories.** Turn 12. Product categories distinguish color-coating and enhancement uses; similar names do not establish an identical service or suitable product.
- 7. retained length.** Turn 14. Retained length is the existing short length Zoe wants to preserve; it is one confirmed preference within a wider consultation.
- 8. service scope.** Turn 16. Service scope records the work being discussed, including the no-added-length boundary, without inventing unconfirmed product or design choices.
- 9. read-back.** Turn 18. Read-back repeats the current short length and no-extension request so Zoe can verify that the image has not displaced the agreement.
- 10. length preference.** Turn 20. Length preference is the confirmed wish to retain the current short nails; the remaining consultation still determines other service details.

F Transfer conversation

Page 12

1. medium

Technician: "The current medium length should be retained."

Medium is the existing length the client explicitly wants to keep.

2. extensions

Client: "No extensions are requested."

The long image does not change the client's no-added-length request.

3. open

Technician: "Product choice remains open."

A length preference does not select the product system or establish suitability.

4. begun

Client: "No work has begun."

Clarification takes place before the service starts in the supplied scenario.

02 Briefing and language checks

Comparing shape and practical length

A Briefing checks / page 13

1. What practical requirement does Amara state?

A. A short result for keyboard work

The client wants short nails because of the way they use a keyboard.

2. Which sample is short in this case?

A. The squoval sample

The brief explicitly contrasts a short squoval sample with a long almond sample.

3. What does Amara choose for discussion?

B. The short squoval appearance

The choice concerns the sample appearance, not a technique or durability guarantee.

D Language checks / page 18

1. Which comparison is accurate?

A. This almond sample is long and tapered; this squoval sample is short with softened corners.

The comparison stays with the supplied visible features and avoids universal claims.

2. Which question best clarifies the next detail?

D. What length reference shall we agree on for your actual nails?

The exact practical length remains to be clarified on the client's actual nails.

3. Which promise is unsupported?

B. This shape will never cause discomfort or break.

Neither comfort nor breakage prevention is established by the visual sample.

4. What does the selected sample establish?

D. A preferred appearance for discussion

The client selects the visible direction while assessment and exact details remain open.

02 Conversation answers

Comparing shape and practical length

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 19-20

1. practical requirement. Turn 2. Practical requirement is the client's need for short nails during keyboard work, which should remain central to the comparison.

2. almond. Turn 4. Almond identifies the sample's narrowing outline and rounded tip, separate from the long length shown in this particular example.

3. squoval. Turn 6. Squoval describes the straighter edge with softened corners shown in the shorter alternative sample.

4. silhouettes. Turn 8. Silhouettes are the visible outer outlines, not instructions about which product or technique must be used.

5. comfort guarantee. Turn 10. Comfort guarantee would promise a daily-use outcome that the sample alone cannot establish for this client.

6. breakage. Turn 12. Breakage is a possible outcome that cannot be ruled out merely by choosing a named shape or looking at a display.

7. preferred outline. Turn 14. Preferred outline is the squoval appearance Amara chooses for discussion, while rejecting the long sample's length.

8. length reference. Turn 16. Length reference is the specific example or measurement to confirm on the actual nails, beyond the broad word short.

9. Softened corners. Turn 18. Softened corners distinguish the chosen squoval appearance from a more sharply square outline in this comparison.

10. suitability assessment. Turn 20. Suitability assessment remains part of the normal professional process; selecting an appearance does not establish a method or guaranteed performance.

F Transfer conversation

Page 21

1. round

Technician: "The preferred shape is round."

The client chooses the round appearance from the two supplied samples.

2. short

Client: "My practical priority is short length."

Short length is the stated preference for keyboard work.

3. measurement

Technician: "The exact measurement still needs agreement."

The broad length preference does not supply a specific agreed measurement.

4. breakage

Client: "No guarantee against breakage has been made."

The visual choice does not establish that the nails cannot break.

03 Briefing and language checks

Explaining color, coverage, and finish

03

A Briefing checks / page 22

1. Which appearance does Dana want?

A. Sheer pink with low shine

Dana wants the pink and transparency of the swatch but a lower-shine finish.

2. What should remain visible?

D. The natural nail line

The client specifically wants the nail line visible through the color.

3. Which product category is booked?

D. Neither lacquer nor gel polish is specified

The booking leaves the product category unspecified, so it requires clarification.

D Language checks / page 27

1. Which statement explains the client's request?

B. Sheer concerns visibility through the color; matte concerns shine.

Coverage and finish are independent appearance dimensions in this consultation.

2. Which swatch feature is not wanted?

C. Its glossy finish

The client likes the color and transparency but asks for low shine.

3. Which record is accurate?

C. Sheer pink, low shine, product category not yet specified.

The record preserves the three appearance details and unresolved product choice.

4. Which question best checks coverage?

A. Do you want the nail line to show through?

Visibility of the nail line directly clarifies the desired coverage.

03 Conversation answers

Explaining color, coverage, and finish

03

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 28-29

1. coverage. Turn 2. Coverage describes how much the color conceals the underlying nail, which Dana clarifies by wanting some detail to remain visible.

2. sheer. Turn 4. Sheer describes the translucent coverage Dana wants, allowing the nail line to remain visible rather than concealing it fully.

3. finish. Turn 6. Finish identifies the surface appearance and shine, separate from the color's transparency or coverage.

4. matte. Turn 8. Matte is the requested low-shine appearance, which differs from the glossy finish on the chosen reference swatch.

5. Opaque. Turn 10. Opaque coverage conceals the underlying nail, unlike the sheer coverage Dana requests with the nail line still visible.

6. sample mismatch. Turn 12. Sample mismatch is limited to the shine: the reference's glossy finish differs from the client's low-shine preference.

7. product category. Turn 14. Product category remains unspecified because the booking does not identify lacquer or gel polish, and the swatch cannot decide it automatically.

8. appearance specification. Turn 16. Appearance specification records the agreed pink color, sheer coverage, and low-shine finish without choosing a product system.

9. nail line. Turn 18. Nail line is the underlying visual detail Dana wants to remain visible through the sheer color.

10. product system. Turn 20. Product system is the service-specific choice still to be assessed; the agreed appearance does not establish its products or application method.

F Transfer conversation

Page 30

1. blue

Technician: "The requested color is blue."

Blue is the chosen color family in this new scenario.

2. opaque

Client: "I want opaque coverage."

Opaque matches the wish to conceal the underlying nail line.

3. glossy

Technician: "The requested finish is glossy."

Glossy specifies the chosen shine independently of coverage.

4. unspecified

Reception: "The product category remains unspecified."

The appearance request does not choose lacquer or gel polish.

04 Briefing and language checks

Agreeing on nail art and a complete quote

04

A Briefing checks / page 31

1. What would four decorated nails cost in total?

B. \$50

Four nails at five dollars add twenty dollars to the thirty-dollar base.

2. Which option meets the \$40 limit with art?

A. Two decorated nails plus the base service

Two nails add ten dollars, making the complete total forty dollars.

3. Which placement is selected?

A. One ring fingernail on each hand

One ring fingernail on each hand gives the agreed total of two decorated nails.

D Language checks / page 36

1. Which quote is complete?

A. Two decorated nails at \$10 plus the \$30 base: \$40 total.

The correct quote states quantity, art subtotal, base price, and final total.

2. What does one ring fingernail on each hand mean?

B. Two decorated nails in total

One selected finger on each of two hands gives two decorated nails.

3. Which response wrongly assumes agreement?

C. I reduced your four-nail design without asking so the bill fits.

A budget constraint does not authorize silently changing the requested design quantity.

4. Which change would exceed the accepted quantity?

B. Decorating two nails on each hand

Two per hand produces four decorated nails rather than the accepted two.

04 Conversation answers

Agreeing on nail art and a complete quote

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 37-38

1. complete quote. Turn 2. Complete quote includes the base service and all selected art, so the client can compare the actual total with the budget.

2. per-nail charge. Turn 4. Per-nail charge applies five dollars to each of four nails, creating twenty dollars in art charges rather than one five-dollar fee.

3. art subtotal. Turn 6. Art subtotal is ten dollars for two nails and must be added to the thirty-dollar base to reach the complete forty-dollar price.

4. base price. Turn 8. Base price remains thirty dollars for the service without the optional line art, giving a second option within the client's limit.

5. quantity reduction. Turn 10. Quantity reduction is the client's explicit choice to move from four decorated nails to two, not a silent change made by the technician.

6. both hands. Turn 12. Both hands means the combined total for left and right, so two across both hands is not two on each hand.

7. accent nail. Turn 14. Accent nail is the individually decorated nail, here one ring fingernail on each hand for two in total.

8. placement. Turn 16. Placement identifies the exact nails receiving the art, which is a separate detail from the overall quantity of two.

9. budget limit. Turn 18. Budget limit is forty dollars for the entire selected service, and the confirmed option meets it with no other charges in this fictional menu.

10. design approval. Turn 20. Design approval covers the specified two ring fingernails, simple line art, and forty-dollar total, not further unrequested additions.

F Transfer conversation

Page 39

1. two

Technician: "The selected quantity is two nails."

One decorated nail on each of two hands gives two nails total.

2. eight

Client: "The art subtotal is eight dollars."

Two nails multiplied by four dollars gives eight dollars for art.

3. forty-three

Technician: "The complete total is forty-three dollars."

The thirty-five-dollar base plus eight dollars of art totals forty-three.

4. limit

Client: "That total meets my budget limit."

The total equals the stated maximum without exceeding it.

05 Briefing and language checks

Responding to discomfort and uncertain nail concerns

A Briefing checks / page 40

1. What does Elena report?

C. Unexplained tenderness beside one nail

The client reports tenderness before any service, with no established cause.

2. What happens to the covering request?

D. It is paused

Dev pauses the cosmetic request rather than covering an unexplained concern.

3. What does referral establish?

C. A route to appropriate health assessment, not service approval

Referral addresses the health concern while cosmetic-service suitability remains a separate decision.

D Language checks / page 45

1. Which note stays factual?

C. Tenderness beside one nail reported before service; covering request paused.

The correct note preserves location, timing, and action without diagnosis or invented causation.

2. Which response overpromises?

B. After the referral, we will definitely perform the requested service.

Referral does not guarantee that the salon will later approve cosmetic work.

3. Which next step addresses the health question?

B. Assessment by an appropriate healthcare professional

The unexplained health concern needs appropriate assessment rather than cosmetic concealment.

4. Which distinction matters?

B. Healthcare assessment and cosmetic-service suitability are separate decisions.

The salon must separately assess the cosmetic service instead of treating referral as approval.

05 Conversation answers

Responding to discomfort and uncertain nail concerns

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 46-47

- 1. pause.** Turn 2. Pause means stopping the covering request before product is applied, rather than carrying on because the client has an event.
- 2. event deadline.** Turn 4. Event deadline explains why Elena wants a cosmetic result but does not establish that applying a product is suitable.
- 3. tenderness.** Turn 6. Tenderness is Elena's own description of the sensation beside one nail, not a diagnosis of its cause.
- 4. pre-existing concern.** Turn 8. Pre-existing concern means it was present before the proposed service, preventing an inaccurate claim that today's product application caused it.
- 5. healthcare professional.** Turn 10. Healthcare professional identifies the appropriate route for assessing an unexplained health concern, rather than asking the nail technician to diagnose or treat it.
- 6. referral.** Turn 12. Referral directs Elena toward appropriate health assessment; it does not itself approve the proposed cosmetic service or guarantee a later appointment.
- 7. Cosmetic suitability.** Turn 14. Cosmetic suitability is the separate salon assessment of the proposed appearance service, not a substitute for healthcare assessment.
- 8. factual note.** Turn 16. Factual note records the reported tenderness, its timing, the paused request, and the referral without inventing a diagnosis.
- 9. diagnosis.** Turn 18. Diagnosis identifies a health condition through appropriate clinical assessment, which the technician has not performed or claimed.
- 10. service approval.** Turn 20. Service approval has not been given: the covering request remains paused even though the client agrees to seek healthcare advice.

F Transfer conversation

Page 48

1. soreness

Technician: "The reported concern is soreness beside one nail."

Soreness is the supplied client description, not an inferred condition.

2. applied

Client: "No product has been applied."

The scenario explicitly keeps the cosmetic application from starting.

3. paused

Technician: "The covering request remains paused."

Referral does not restart or authorize the cosmetic service.

4. unassessed

Reception: "Cosmetic suitability is still unassessed."

The salon must assess suitability separately from the healthcare referral.

05

06 Briefing and language checks

Giving a clear station-readiness update

A Briefing checks / page 49

1. Which station is confirmed ready?

C. Station two

Rosa has confirmed station two ready through the relevant salon process.

2. What is station three's status?

B. Tidy, with required checks incomplete

Appearance and readiness differ; station three still has incomplete required checks.

3. What time will station three be ready?

C. No completion time is known

The case supplies no verified completion time for the pending station.

D Language checks / page 54

1. Which handover is accurate?

C. Two confirmed ready by Rosa; three tidy with checks incomplete.

The correct message preserves both station numbers and their different verified statuses.

2. Which message should reception give the client?

B. A confirmed-ready station is available at station two.

Station two provides the verified option without inventing readiness for station three.

3. What would justify updating station three's status?

A. Completion of its required checks and the actual readiness confirmation

Readiness must follow the required process rather than appearance or scheduling pressure.

4. Which question is most precise?

C. Has station three received the required readiness confirmation?

The question asks about the specific unresolved status rather than a vague impression.

06 Conversation answers

Giving a clear station-readiness update

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 55-56

1. tidy. Turn 2. Tidy describes its visible order, but does not establish that the required readiness checks are complete.

2. available alternative. Turn 4. Available alternative is station two, whose readiness has been confirmed rather than inferred from appearance.

3. confirmed ready. Turn 6. Confirmed ready is the verified status for station two, with Rosa identified as the responsible confirmation source.

4. completion time. Turn 8. Completion time for station three is unknown, so Owen cannot supply a reliable ready-at promise.

5. readiness handover. Turn 10. Readiness handover transfers the verified station status and available next step, not instructions for performing the checks.

6. pending status. Turn 12. Pending status makes the unfinished checks explicit, avoiding a vague almost-ready label that could be treated as approval to use the station.

7. responsible technician. Turn 14. Responsible technician identifies who confirmed station two through the relevant process, rather than implying an anonymous or assumed approval.

8. release confirmation. Turn 16. Release confirmation is the actual readiness decision after the required checks, not a conclusion based only on a cleared work surface.

9. client-facing message. Turn 18. Client-facing message gives the useful verified option without unnecessary procedural detail or an unsupported promise about station three.

10. read-back. Turn 20. Read-back repeats station numbers, confirmation source, and the unknown time, catching errors before the client is directed to a station.

F Transfer conversation

Page 57

1. one

Reception: "The verified alternative is station one."

Jo has confirmed station one ready, making it the available option.

2. pending

Technician: "Station five remains pending."

Its required checks are incomplete despite the tidy appearance.

3. Jo

Reception: "The confirming technician for one is Jo."

Jo is the named source of the station-one readiness confirmation.

4. time

Technician: "Five has no confirmed completion time."

The brief supplies no reliable time for station five to become ready.

07 Briefing and language checks

Handling a chip or design concern

A Briefing checks / page 58

1. What direction was requested and recorded?

C. Lettering facing toward the client

The service record confirms the client's original toward-client request.

2. What is available today?

D. A no-fee review at 4:00

The available appointment is a review, not a preapproved remedy.

3. What does no review fee mean?

D. The review itself has no charge

The fee statement applies only to the review, not unassessed additional work.

D Language checks / page 63

1. Which acknowledgment matches the record?

A. You requested lettering facing toward you, and that direction is recorded.

The existing service record supports the client's original toward-client direction.

2. Which promise exceeds the supplied facts?

B. Every correction will be free and completed during the review.

Correction price, method, and completion time have not been assessed or approved.

3. Which concern should the case note identify?

A. A lettering-orientation mismatch

The complaint concerns design direction rather than an invented health or wear issue.

4. Which confirmation is accurate after acceptance?

A. Today at 4:00 with Rosa for a no-fee review of the direction concern.

The confirmation states the agreed review and its limited fee scope.

07 Conversation answers

Handling a chip or design concern

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 64-65

1. service record. Turn 2. Service record confirms the original toward-client direction, so the concern is not a new preference.

2. orientation mismatch. Turn 4. Orientation mismatch identifies the difference between the recorded toward-client request and the reported away-facing result.

3. review appointment. Turn 6. Review appointment is the available opportunity to examine the concern today at 4:00, not a preapproved correction service.

4. review fee. Turn 8. Review fee applies to the assessment appointment itself; its absence does not determine the cost of any unassessed further work.

5. correction method. Turn 10. Correction method has not been assessed or approved, so Alex cannot promise a specific way of changing the finished design.

6. remedy decision. Turn 12. Remedy decision follows the review and relevant agreement; accepting the review does not automatically authorize further work.

7. completion promise. Turn 14. Completion promise would guarantee a finish time for unassessed work; the review slot does not establish that.

8. case note. Turn 16. Case note records the toward-client request, reported away-facing lettering, and accepted review rather than a vague or different concern.

9. viewing perspective. Turn 18. Viewing perspective identifies the client as the intended reader, keeping direction separate from chipping or wear.

10. review confirmation. Turn 20. Review confirmation covers the accepted 4:00 no-fee review, not the method, price, or timing of a correction.

F Transfer conversation

Page 66

1. away

Reception: "The recorded direction is away from the client."

Away is the documented original direction in this new case.

2. 11:00

Client: "The accepted review is tomorrow at 11:00."

The brief gives eleven o'clock as the agreed review time.

3. fee

Reception: "The review itself has no fee."

The no-charge statement applies specifically to the review appointment.

4. agreed

Reception: "No correction method is agreed."

Accepting the review does not establish a particular correction plan.

08 Briefing and language checks

Scheduling follow-up and handing over exact requests

A Briefing checks / page 67

1. What appearance does the client request?

A. Plain color with no nail art

The client requests plain color and explicitly declines additional nail art.

2. What is unknown?

D. The identity of the existing product

An existing product is reported, but its identity has not been established.

3. What is Friday at 10:00?

C. A requested time, not a booking

The brief explicitly leaves the requested time unaccepted and unbooked.

D Language checks / page 72

1. Which handover is accurate?

C. Plain color, no art, Friday 10:00 requested; existing product unidentified.

The correct handover preserves appearance, timing status, and the unresolved product identity.

2. What must precede confirmation of removal time?

D. The consultation needed to assess the existing product and service

The brief requires consultation before a removal duration can be confirmed.

3. Which phrase makes an unsupported commitment?

B. Your infill is confirmed for Friday at ten.

Neither infill suitability nor an accepted appointment is established.

4. What does reception taking responsibility mean?

B. Reception owns the next availability discussion.

Ownership assigns the pending action without changing any unfinished assessment or booking status.

08 Conversation answers

Scheduling follow-up and handing over exact requests

E Dialogue gaps

Pages 73-74

- 1. plain-color request.** Turn 2. Plain-color request records the desired appearance without selecting a removal method, infill, or confirmed appointment.
- 2. declined option.** Turn 4. Declined option is nail art, which the client explicitly excludes rather than leaving open for an unrequested design choice.
- 3. requested time.** Turn 6. Requested time is Friday at 10:00 as a preference, not an accepted or confirmed appointment.
- 4. unidentified product.** Turn 8. Unidentified product means material is present but its identity is unknown; it must not be recorded as no product.
- 5. consultation prerequisite.** Turn 10. Consultation prerequisite means assessment must come before confirming removal duration or whether an infill is appropriate.
- 6. infill.** Turn 12. Infill is a maintenance service for an existing enhancement when suitable; its name does not establish that it is appropriate for this unidentified product.
- 7. removal duration.** Turn 14. Removal duration is the time needed for the actual service, which cannot be confirmed from an unidentified product or another client's appointment.
- 8. pending action.** Turn 16. Pending action is the consultation availability discussion, which has not yet resulted in an accepted appointment or assessed service.
- 9. handover owner.** Turn 18. Handover owner identifies Malik as responsible for the next discussion without claiming that the consultation or booking has already been completed.
- 10. client confirmation.** Turn 20. Client confirmation is the explicit agreement still needed for an offered consultation appointment; a requested time alone does not provide it.

F Transfer conversation

Page 75

1. Tuesday

Technician: "The requested day is Tuesday."

Tuesday is the stated preference, not proof of an accepted appointment.

2. unidentified

Reception: "Existing product remains unidentified."

Product is present, but its identity has not been established.

3. reception

Technician: "The next availability discussion belongs to reception."

Reception is assigned the pending consultation discussion in the handover.

4. confirmed

Reception: "Removal time cannot yet be confirmed."

Consultation must precede confirmation of the unassessed removal duration.

08

Find the move you need

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

01 Clarifying the service and the intended length

Clarify the label: When you say full set, do you mean added length?

Separate image and instruction: The photo shows long nails, but we should confirm your own length preference.

Avoid a product assumption: We have not selected the product system yet.

Full phrase set: pages 7-8 | Dialogue: pages 10-11

02 Comparing shape and practical length

Ask about daily use: What length feels practical for your keyboard work?

Describe the alternative: The squoval sample shown here is short.

Preserve the practical limit: Your priority is a short result.

Full phrase set: pages 16-17 | Dialogue: pages 19-20

03 Explaining color, coverage, and finish

Separate the choices: Let us check color, coverage, and finish one at a time.

Explain sheer: Sheer coverage allows some nail detail to show through.

Identify the mismatch: You like its pink color and coverage, but not its shine.

Full phrase set: pages 25-26 | Dialogue: pages 28-29

04 Agreeing on nail art and a complete quote

Ask about the limit: Is \$40 your total budget, including the base service?

Calculate the first option: Four decorated nails add \$20, making \$50 total.

Ask for a choice: Would you prefer two decorated nails or the base service alone?

Full phrase set: pages 34-35 | Dialogue: pages 37-38

Keep the conversation productive

Use these as precise language models. Replace details only when you know the actual facts, authority, and agreed conditions.

05 Responding to discomfort and uncertain nail concerns

Acknowledge the concern: Thank you for telling me about the tenderness.

Pause the request: I will pause the request to cover that area with product.

Acknowledge the event: I understand why you wanted a cosmetic result for the event.

Full phrase set: pages 43-44 | Dialogue: pages 46-47

06 Giving a clear station-readiness update

Identify the station: Station three is the one still awaiting checks.

State the verified alternative: Station two has been confirmed ready.

Avoid a guessed time: I do not have a confirmed completion time for station three.

Full phrase set: pages 52-53 | Dialogue: pages 55-56

07 Handling a chip or design concern

Acknowledge the detail: You requested the lettering facing toward you.

Avoid an argument over preference: We do not need to treat the recorded direction as a new request.

Avoid expanding the fee statement: No review fee does not establish the price of unassessed further work.

Full phrase set: pages 61-62 | Dialogue: pages 64-65

08 Scheduling follow-up and handing over exact requests

Open the handover: I have a plain-color request with an unidentified existing product.

Prevent a booking assumption: That time is requested, not booked.

Avoid a standard-time guess: I cannot assign a removal duration from the current information.

Full phrase set: pages 70-71 | Dialogue: pages 73-74

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

accent nail	select an accent nail	32
acrylic	clarify the acrylic service	6
added length	decline added length	6
additional charge	state the additional charge	33
adjacent skin	describe adjacent skin	41
affected area	identify the affected area	41
allergic reaction	refer a suspected allergic reaction	41
almond	describe the almond sample	14
appearance specification	record the appearance specification	24
art subtotal	calculate the art subtotal	33
availability discussion	hold an availability discussion	69
available alternative	offer the available alternative	51
base price	state the base price	33
both hands	total across both hands	33
breakage	avoid a breakage guarantee	15
budget limit	respect the budget limit	33
builder gel	discuss builder gel terminology	5
case note	update the case note	60
check record	update the check record	51
chip	report a chip	59
clean storage	identify clean storage	50
cleaning	distinguish cleaning from disinfection	50
client confirmation	obtain client confirmation	69
coffin	describe the coffin silhouette	14

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

color coat	identify the color coat	24
comfort expectation	clarify the comfort expectation	15
complete quote	give a complete quote	33
completion promise	avoid an unsupported completion promise	60
confirmed appointment	distinguish a confirmed appointment	69
confirmed ready	report confirmed-ready status	50
consultation	complete the consultation	6
consultation prerequisite	explain the consultation prerequisite	69
correction estimate	provide a correction estimate	60
correction method	assess the correction method	60
cosmetic request	pause the cosmetic request	42
cosmetic suitability	assess cosmetic suitability	42
coverage	clarify the coverage	23
covering product	decline to apply a covering product	42
current length	check the current length	6
daily use	ask about daily use	15
declined option	record the declined option	69
decorated nail	count decorated nails	32
design approval	obtain design approval	33
design brief	refer to the design brief	59
design concern	acknowledge a design concern	59
diagnosis	avoid giving a diagnosis	42
disinfection	refer to disinfection requirements	50
documented request	acknowledge the documented request	59

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

dot detail clarify the dot detail	32
each hand confirm one on each hand	33
enhancement clarify the enhancement	5
event deadline acknowledge the event deadline	42
existing product identify the existing product	68
extension confirm whether extensions are wanted	5
facing away report lettering facing away	59
facing toward confirm lettering facing toward the client	59
factual note make a factual note	42
file-off distinguish a file-off category	68
finish clarify the finish	23
finished result review the finished result	59
form distinguish a form from a tip	5
free edge discuss the free edge	5
French tip discuss a French-tip design	32
full set clarify the full-set request	5
gel polish distinguish gel polish	6
glitter distinguish glitter from gloss	24
glossy identify the glossy swatch	24
handover owner name the handover owner	69
healthcare professional refer to a healthcare professional	42
hue describe the hue	23
infill assess whether an infill is suitable	68
irritation report possible irritation	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

keyboard work discuss keyboard work	15
lacquer identify nail lacquer	6
legibility discuss legibility	59
length preference record the length preference	6
length reference confirm a length reference	15
lettering check the lettering	59
lifting report lifting	60
line art quote simple line art	32
local exhaust identify local exhaust	51
maintenance appointment clarify the maintenance appointment	69
matte request a matte finish	23
measurement agree on a measurement	15
metallic describe a metallic effect	24
motif choose a motif	32
nail art specify the nail art	32
nail bed distinguish nail bed and plate	5
nail fold identify the nail-fold area	41
nail line retain a visible nail line	23
nail plate refer to the nail plate	5
natural nail identify the natural nail	5
natural-nail overlay discuss a natural-nail overlay	5
negative space identify negative space	32
ombre describe an ombre effect	33
onset clarify reported onset	41

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

opaque distinguish opaque coverage	23
orientation clarify the orientation	32
orientation mismatch acknowledge an orientation mismatch	59
oval describe an oval outline	14
overlay clarify the overlay	5
pearlescent compare a pearlescent effect	24
pending action identify the pending action	69
pending status keep the pending status	50
per-nail charge explain the per-nail charge	33
personal protective equipment confirm required personal protective equipment	51
placement confirm design placement	32
plain color choose plain color	32
plain-color request preserve the plain-color request	69
practical requirement record the practical requirement	15
pre-existing concern record a pre-existing concern	42
preferred outline confirm the preferred outline	15
previous provider clarify the previous provider	68
product identity confirm product identity	68
product label consult the product label	51
product system confirm the product system	24
proportion compare proportions	15
provisional duration avoid an unsupported provisional duration	69
quantity reduction confirm a quantity reduction	33
read-back give a length read-back	6

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

readiness check	complete a readiness check	50
readiness handover	give a readiness handover	51
rebalance	discuss rebalance terminology	68
redness	record reported redness	41
reference image	interpret the reference image	6
referral	explain the referral	42
refund approval	distinguish refund approval	60
regrowth area	identify the regrowth area	68
release confirmation	await release confirmation	51
remedy decision	separate the remedy decision	60
removal consultation	arrange a removal consultation	68
removal duration	assess removal duration	68
requested time	record the requested time	69
responsible technician	name the responsible technician	51
retained length	confirm retained length	6
reusable implement	identify a reusable implement	50
review appointment	confirm the review appointment	60
review confirmation	send the review confirmation	60
review fee	clarify the review fee	60
ring fingernail	identify the ring fingernail	33
round	compare a round shape	14
rounded tip	identify the rounded tip	14
safety data sheet	locate the safety data sheet	51
sample display	use the sample display	15

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

sample mismatch clarify the sample mismatch	24
satin compare a satin finish	24
semi-sheer compare semi-sheer coverage	23
sensitivity clarify reported sensitivity	41
service approval distinguish service approval	42
service history review service history	68
service label clarify the service label	6
service pause maintain the service pause	42
service record check the service record	59
service scope confirm the service scope	6
service tray identify the service tray	50
shade choose a pink shade	23
sheen describe the sheen	24
sheer request sheer coverage	23
shimmer identify shimmer	24
silhouette compare the silhouettes	14
single-use item identify a single-use item	50
soak-off clarify a soak-off category	68
softened corners describe softened corners	14
specific acknowledgment give a specific acknowledgment	60
square identify the square shape	14
squoval explain the squoval outline	14
station identify the station	50
status correction make a status correction	69

Find a term and its context

The page number leads to the definition and a typical word combination. Repeated terms have separate entries when they serve different lesson contexts.

stiletto identify the stiletto sample	14
straight edge identify the straight edge	14
stripe describe a stripe	32
suitability assessment complete a suitability assessment	15
swatch compare the swatch	23
swelling describe reported swelling	41
symmetry discuss symmetry	15
symptom description preserve the symptom description	41
tapered sides compare tapered sides	14
tenderness report tenderness	41
tidiness distinguish tidiness from readiness	50
tip identify an extension tip	5
top coat discuss the top coat	24
translucency describe translucency	23
treatment advice avoid unsupported treatment advice	42
undertone compare undertones	23
unexplained concern acknowledge an unexplained concern	41
unidentified product record an unidentified product	68
used-item area identify the used-item area	51
ventilation report a ventilation concern	51
viewing perspective clarify the viewing perspective	59
waste container check the waste container	51
wear concern record a wear concern	60
work surface check work-surface status	50

Original cases. Clear boundaries.

These are original fictional teaching conversations, not transcripts of real workers. Names, figures, organizations, and incidents are invented. Sources support terminology and communication aims, not the fictional results or an endorsement of this book.

[1] US Food and Drug Administration. Nail Care Products.

[Open the original source](#)

Background for product directions, warnings, and the distinction between cosmetic services and treatment of health problems. No medical or chemical procedure is taught. Checked 1 October 2026.

[2] Occupational Safety and Health Administration. Health Hazards in Nail Salons.

[Open the original source](#)

Context for chemical, biological, and ergonomic concerns and the need for actual workplace checks. The readiness dialogue does not supply disinfection instructions. Checked 1 October 2026.

[3] OPI. How to Shape Nails.

[Open the original source](#)

Manufacturer vocabulary for visible shape distinctions such as almond, square, and squoval. The book compares appearances and does not reproduce shaping steps or durability claims. Checked 1 October 2026.

[4] Creative Nail Design. Troubleshooting and FAQs: PLEXIGEL Q&A.

[Open the original source](#)

The linked manufacturer FAQ distinguishes enhancement uses and product-dependent removal. This book teaches terminology without endorsing a product or reproducing application instructions. Checked 1 October 2026.

Phil Stilwell

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